

Programme «Pedagogy»

**DEVELOPMENT AND APPROBATION OF A LEVEL-BASED
MODEL OF DIFFERENTIATED ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING
IN GRADE 6 AS A MEANS OF CORRECTING AND DEVELOPING
BASIC SPEECH SKILLS
(Master's Thesis)**

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INTRODUCTION

1. Relevance and Significance of the Study

Contemporary secondary education in the Kyrgyz Republic is characterised by a pronounced sociolinguistic heterogeneity within its student population. In the context of structurally determined multilingualism where English functions as the third language of instruction following Kyrgyz and Russian learners within a single classroom frequently exhibit substantially divergent levels of linguistic preparation, a disparity that is particularly acute in rural educational settings. This structural reality presents a fundamental pedagogical challenge: state educational policy, as codified in the State Educational Standard of School General Education of the Kyrgyz Republic and the Subject Standard 'English Language' for Grades 5–11, mandates that all students attain defined proficiency targets aligned with the descriptors of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) upon the completion of each academic year. Grade 6 students, for instance, are expected to reach the A2+ (Pre-Intermediate) proficiency threshold by the end of the academic cycle – a requirement that presupposes a degree of language preparedness that a significant proportion of learners in rural multilingual schools does not yet possess upon entering the grade.

The contradiction between these standardised normative requirements and the genuine variability of students' starting proficiency levels renders traditional, uniform whole-class instruction pedagogically insufficient as a means of ensuring that all learners achieve the prescribed outcomes. A fundamentally different instructional approach is required – one that preserves the unity of educational goals while simultaneously accommodating the individual developmental trajectories of each student. It is precisely this pedagogical challenge that the level-based model of differentiated instruction is designed to address: by providing a principled framework for organising educational activity in accordance with each learner's actual proficiency level, as operationalised through the CEFR descriptors, the model creates the conditions under which all students can make measurable progress toward the common communicative objectives of the curriculum. The problem

acquires special urgency in rural schools, where resource constraints, limited access to qualified professional development, and the complex multilingual sociolinguistic environment compound the difficulty of achieving the normatively prescribed outcomes in English language education.

The present research was conducted within the framework of the priority directions of pedagogical science and educational policy in the Kyrgyz Republic, specifically in the area of improving the quality of foreign language instruction in general secondary education institutions. The research is grounded in the requirements of the State Educational Standard of School General Education of the Kyrgyz Republic and the Subject Standard 'English Language' for Grades 5–11, which orient instruction toward a communicative-competence approach and the attainment of CEFR-aligned proficiency descriptors. The study was conducted on an initiative basis at the 'Amanat' Secondary School, Oktyabr village, Alamudun District, Chuy Region.

2. Purpose and Research Objectives

The purpose of the present study is to develop, implement, and appraise a level-based model of differentiated English language instruction in Grade 6 classrooms as an instrument for the correction and development of the basic speech skills of learners with heterogeneous linguistic profiles.

In pursuit of this purpose, the following research objectives were formulated:

1. To examine theoretical approaches to level-based differentiation and the concept of basic speech skills within the methodology of foreign language teaching.
2. To analyse and systematise the scientific and methodological foundations of differentiated instruction as a pedagogical technology.
3. To substantiate the theoretical and methodological basis of the level-based model of differentiated instruction on the basis of the student-centred and systemic-activity approaches, the concept of the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), and the CEFR proficiency descriptors.

4.To develop and implement the level-based model of differentiated instruction in Grade 6 classrooms under authentic instructional conditions in a rural multilingual school.

5.To analyse the results of the pedagogical experiment and to establish the effectiveness of the developed model as a means of correcting and developing the basic speech skills of learners.

3. Scientific Novelty of the Research Findings

For the first time, a level-based model of differentiated English language instruction adapted to the conditions of a rural school in the Kyrgyz Republic — in which English constitutes the third language of instruction — has been developed and subjected to empirical verification at the Grade 6 level. The study generates new knowledge concerning the pedagogical conditions that simultaneously ensure the correction of foundational speech skill deficits and the maintenance of academic motivation among learners with heterogeneous linguistic profiles. A diagnostic and monitoring toolkit – comprising Instructional Monitoring Protocols and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets has been developed and calibrated to the three-tier organisational structure of the model. The study further substantiates the legitimacy of integrating AI-assisted language generation tools as a resource for the rapid and systematic adaptation of instructional tasks to the proficiency profile of each level group within a unified thematic module.

4. Practical Significance of the Research Findings

The level-based model of differentiated instruction developed in the present study is directly applicable by English language teachers in general secondary schools of the Kyrgyz Republic, and is particularly suited to the conditions of rural educational institutions. The three-tier task matrix, the Instructional Monitoring Protocols, and the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets constitute a ready-to-use methodological toolkit adaptable to any thematic module within a standard curriculum. The findings of the study may be utilised in the design of professional development programmes for English language teachers, as well as in the preparation of students enrolled in pedagogical degree programmes.

5. Principal Theses Submitted for Defence

The following theses, grounded in the findings of the present research, are submitted for academic defence:

1. The level-based model of differentiated English language instruction for Grade 6 classrooms predicated on the diagnostic stratification of learners into three proficiency-based groups (Correction and Support; Standard and Guidance; Autonomous Development) in accordance with the CEFR descriptors ensures the unity of educational goals while providing variable pathways for their attainment, as evidenced by the universal positive growth recorded across all 24 participants in the pedagogical experiment.

2. The five-stage structure of the differentiated lesson (warm-up → presentation → controlled practice → productive stage → reflection and conclusion), within which systematic differentiation is concentrated at the productive stage through the deployment of a three-tier task matrix, constitutes an effective organisational mechanism for the simultaneous satisfaction of the educational needs of learners at all proficiency levels within a single class group.

3. The application of scaffolding instruments including substitution tables, dialogue skeletons, and sentence frames in combination with systematic progress monitoring through Instructional Monitoring Protocols and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets yields a statistically significant gain in the basic speech skills of Level 1 learners and creates the pedagogical conditions for their transition to a higher proficiency tier.

4. Level-based differentiation in a multilingual rural school of the Kyrgyz Republic, where English constitutes the third language of instruction, is not a methodological preference but a pedagogical necessity: it eliminates the demotivating effect of undifferentiated instruction and creates a 'situation of success' for each learner, as confirmed by the qualitative evidence of the Self-Assessment Sheets and Instructional Monitoring Protocols.

6. Personal Contribution of the Researcher

The present dissertation was conducted independently by the author. The level-based model of differentiated instruction was personally designed by the author, who was likewise responsible for the creation of the complete package of didactic and diagnostic materials — comprising Instructional Monitoring Protocols, Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets, and three-tier task matrices for 16 lessons — and for the conduct of the pedagogical experiment under authentic classroom conditions. All data collection, processing, and interpretation were performed by the author. The academic supervisor provided overall scholarly guidance throughout the research process.

7. Approbation of the Research Findings

The principal findings and conclusions of the present dissertation were approbated in the course of a pedagogical experiment conducted in Grade 6 at the 'Amanat' Secondary School, Oktyabr village, Alamudun District, Chuy Region, Kyrgyz Republic (January–March 2026). The results of the study have been consistently validated through the triangulation of three independent data sources standardised proficiency testing, Instructional Monitoring Protocols, and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets ensuring the reliability and validity of the conclusions presented herein.

8. Structure and Scope of the Dissertation

The work consists of an introduction, three substantive chapters each followed by conclusions, a general conclusion, practical recommendations for practitioners, a list of references, and a series of appendices. Chapter I is devoted to the theoretical and methodological foundations of the research (Sections 1.1 through 1.4) and provides a systematic review of the scholarly literature on level-based differentiation, differentiated instruction as a pedagogical technology, basic speech skills, and the theoretical approaches underpinning the proposed model. Chapter II presents the research methodology (Sections 2.1 and 2.2), encompassing the object, subject, and methods of the research, as well as the organisation and stages of the pedagogical experiment. Chapter III presents the experimental and empirical work on the design and implementation of the level-based model (Sections 3.1 and 3.2), encompassing

the content and practical implementation of the model and a comprehensive quantitative and qualitative analysis of the experimental results. The total volume of the work amounts to 61 pages of main text, inclusive of 12 tables, 5 figures, 8 appendices, and a bibliography of 80 sources.

CHAPTER I. THEORETICAL AND METHODOLOGICAL FOUNDATIONS OF THE RESEARCH

1.1. English Language Proficiency Levels and the Concept of a Level-Based Teaching Model

Language proficiency levels serve as the foundational metric for assessing a learner's functional capacity to use a language across diverse communicative contexts. In the era of globalisation, such levels have become a prerequisite for academic mobility and professional engagement – determining whether a person can operate effectively in specific domains of everyday or professional life. This relevance is especially pronounced in the Kyrgyz Republic, where the classroom is characterised by a structurally determined multilingualism: in Kyrgyz-medium schools, English functions as a third language (L3) following Kyrgyz (L1) and Russian (L2), while in Russian-medium schools English enters after Russian (L1) and Kyrgyz (L2). As a result, students exhibit markedly varying degrees of proficiency even within the same grade and curriculum cycle.

This heterogeneity constitutes the central pedagogical challenge addressed by the present research. Harmer (2007, p. 90) observes that the same learning task cannot be equally appropriate for all learners, given the diversity of cognitive profiles present in any classroom. At the same time, the *State Educational Standard of School General Education of the Kyrgyz Republic* (Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic, 2025) mandates that all students attain defined proficiency targets by the end of each grade. As Timerkhanov and Katsay (2018, p. 207) note, this tension between individual variation and standardised outcomes renders traditional whole-class instruction inadequate. The level-based teaching model emerges as a principled response: a bridge that preserves unified educational goals while accommodating the individual learning trajectories of each student.

Before examining the structure of proficiency levels, it is necessary to clarify what exactly is being measured, that is, to establish the concept of language competence as the object of assessment and instruction. Brown (2007, p. 43) argues

that language proficiency cannot be reduced to the mastery of grammatical rules; it encompasses the learner's capacity to deploy linguistic resources in authentic communicative contexts. The most influential reformulation of this insight was offered by Canale and Swain (1980), who identified four interrelated components of communicative competence: *grammatical competence* (mastery of linguistic codes), *sociolinguistic competence* (context-appropriate language use), *discourse competence* (the production of coherent texts), and *strategic competence* (compensatory verbal and non-verbal strategies). This multidimensional understanding underlies the CEFR's operationalisation of proficiency developed in full in Section 1.3, and directly informs the design of level-based tasks in the present study.

The Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR), published by the Council of Europe (Council of Europe, 2001) provides the international standard for describing and measuring language proficiency. Developed in response to the fragmentation of language qualifications across European educational systems, the CEFR offers a shared metalanguage applicable across languages and national contexts. It organises proficiency into six reference levels : A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2 grouped into three broad bands: Basic User (A), Independent User (B), and Proficient User (C). As shown in Table 1.1, each level corresponds to a widely used pedagogical label (Harmer (2007, p. 20)).

Table 1.1.

CEFR Proficiency Levels and Corresponding Pedagogical Terms
(Source: Adapted from Harmer, J. (2007, p. 20). Pearson Longman)

CEFR Level	Pedagogical Label
A1	Beginner / False Beginners
A2	Elementary
B1	Pre-Intermediate

CEFR Level	Pedagogical Label
B2	Intermediate / Upper-Intermediate
C1	Advanced
C2	Mastery / Proficiency

Crucially, these six levels represent points along a continuum rather than discrete categories: a student may be positioned as "low B1" or "strong A2", reflecting the gradual and non-linear nature of acquisition. The CEFR operationalises proficiency through can-do statements, that, positively formulated descriptors focusing on demonstrated communicative ability rather than gaps in knowledge. These descriptors are differentiated across all four skill areas. Table 1.2 illustrates their progressive scope for writing.

Table 1.2.

ALTE Can-Do Statements for Writing Skills Across CEFR Levels
(Source: Adapted from Harmer, J. (2007, p. 21). Originally produced by
ALTE – Association of Language Testers in Europe)

Level	Can-Do Descriptor (Writing)
A1	Can complete basic forms and write notes including times, dates and places.
A2	Can complete forms and write short simple letters or postcards related to personal information.
B1	Can write letters or make notes on familiar or predictable matters.
B2	Can make notes while someone is talking or write a letter including non-standard questions.
C1	Can prepare/draft professional correspondence, take reasonably accurate notes in meetings or write an essay which shows an ability to communicate.
C2	Can write letters on any subject and full notes of meetings or seminars with good expression or accuracy.

Within the level-based model, the CEFR performs two essential functions. First, it serves a diagnostic function, which equipping the teacher with a precise instrument for identifying each student's current competence profile. Second, it fulfils a goal-setting function, that, translating abstract educational standards into concrete, measurable learning targets. However, because CEFR macro-level descriptors are necessarily broad, their instructional application requires micro-level operationalisation: their "unpacking" into a system of progressively specific learning outcomes aligned to particular topics and lessons. As Vanyagina (2025, p. 168) observes, descriptors are variable constructs that must be elaborated into smaller, granular outcomes – transforming an abstract goal into a practical instrument guiding both learner performance and teacher assessment.

The international CEFR framework has been integrated into the national educational policy of the Kyrgyz Republic. The *Subject Standard "English Language" for Grades 5–11* (Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic, 2022, p. 15) establishes CEFR-aligned proficiency targets for each stage of schooling, ensuring the comparability of outcomes and supporting students' academic and professional mobility. As shown in Table 1.3, the requirements are distributed progressively across grades.

Table 1.3.

CEFR Proficiency Levels by Grade (Kyrgyz Republic)

Proficiency Band	CEFR Level	Grade	Pedagogical Label
Basic User	A2 –Elementary	Grade 5	Elementary
Basic User	A2+ –Pre-threshold	Grade 6	Pre-Intermediate
Basic User	A2+ – Pre-threshold	Grade 7	Pre-Intermediate
Basic User	A2+ – Pre-threshold	Grade 8	Pre-Intermediate
Independent User	B1 – Threshold	Grade 9	Intermediate

Proficiency Band	CEFR Level	Grade	Pedagogical Label
Independent User	B1 – Threshold	Grade 10	Intermediate
Independent User	B1+ –Threshold	Grade 11	Intermediate

Grade 6 occupies a particularly significant position within this progression, marking the transition from the A2 (Elementary) to the A2+ (Pre-Intermediate) stage. At this level, the CEFR descriptors (Council of Europe, 2001) require the learner to: understand the main points of clear speech on familiar topics; participate in simple, predictable conversations; write short, simple texts about personal experiences; and comprehend straightforward written passages on everyday themes. These descriptors define the unified goal toward which all learners in Grade 6 must progress – and it is precisely this goal that the level-based model must accommodate through differentiated pathways.

The concept of level-based teaching has been defined by scholars from various methodological traditions. A comparative analysis of three foundational definitions reveals both a shared conceptual core and significant differences in emphasis relevant to the present study.

Firsov (1994, p. 2) defines level-based differentiation as "an organisation of instruction in which students, studying within a unified curriculum and in the same class group, are able to master the material at different levels of complexity." Selevko (1998, p. 92) places greater emphasis on structure, describing it as a technology that "provides for level differentiation through the division of student streams into flexible and relatively homogeneous groups, each of which masters the curriculum content at both basic and variable levels." Bukharkina (2003, p. 48) shifts focus to the individual, defining multi-level instruction as "an organisation of the educational process in which each student has the opportunity to master the curriculum content at different levels (A, B, C), depending on their abilities and individual characteristics." Table 1.4 presents a systematic comparison of these three positions.

Comparative Analysis of Definitions of Level-Based Teaching

Author	Core criterion for differentiation	Organisational emphasis
Firsov (1994, p. 2)	Depth of content mastery within a unified curriculum	Learner works within a common programme; complexity of mastery varies individually
Selevko (1998, p. 92)	Structural grouping of students into flexible homogeneous units	Stream division into basic and variable levels of curriculum coverage
Bukharkina (2003, p. 48)	Individual abilities and personal characteristics of each learner	Opportunity for every student to master content at level A, B, or C independently

All three authors share the view that instruction should enable students to engage with content at varying levels of complexity. The key divergence lies in the criterion for differentiation: Selevko prioritises structural grouping, while Firsov and Bukharkina foreground individual learner characteristics. Crucially, none of the three addresses the specific demands of foreign language education, where the primary criterion for differentiation is not general cognitive ability but the learner's actual level of language proficiency and communicative competence.

For the purposes of the present study, the working definition of the level-based teaching model is understood as the organisation of the instructional process in which students are able to engage with content at different levels of complexity in accordance with their current level of English language proficiency. This definition is grounded primarily in Bukharkina's (2003) framework, adapted to foreground language proficiency – rather than general cognitive ability – as the central differentiating criterion. The CEFR proficiency scale serves as the primary instrument for determining and describing learner levels in this context.

1.2. Differentiated Instruction as a Pedagogical Technology

Having established the conceptual definition of the level-based teaching model, it is instructive to situate it in relation to the traditional approach to instruction. In a homogeneous classroom, where all students share a comparable level of linguistic preparation, the traditional whole-class model can function effectively. However, as established above, this condition is rarely met in the contemporary English language classrooms of the Kyrgyz Republic, where significant heterogeneity in students' proficiency levels is the norm rather than the exception.

According to Tomlinson (2001, p. 2), in an effective differentiated classroom the entire instructional process is directed toward the individual learner: content, pace, and assessment are all adapted to meet each student's actual level of readiness. The teacher's role is thereby transformed from that of a knowledge transmitter into that of a facilitator who designs learning pathways and provides targeted support. In the traditional model, by contrast, instruction is organised around a hypothetical average student, with a fixed pace and uniform tasks for all, leaving little room for individual variation.

Nevertheless, the two approaches are not entirely opposed. Both operate within the framework of a state-mandated curriculum and rely on structured instructional materials: textbooks and syllabi as primary vehicles for content delivery. Both presuppose the presence of a teacher as an essential mediator of learning, and both are committed to the goal of ensuring student achievement. The fundamental difference lies not in the goal, but in the means: where the traditional model assumes uniformity, the level-based model treats diversity as its starting point.

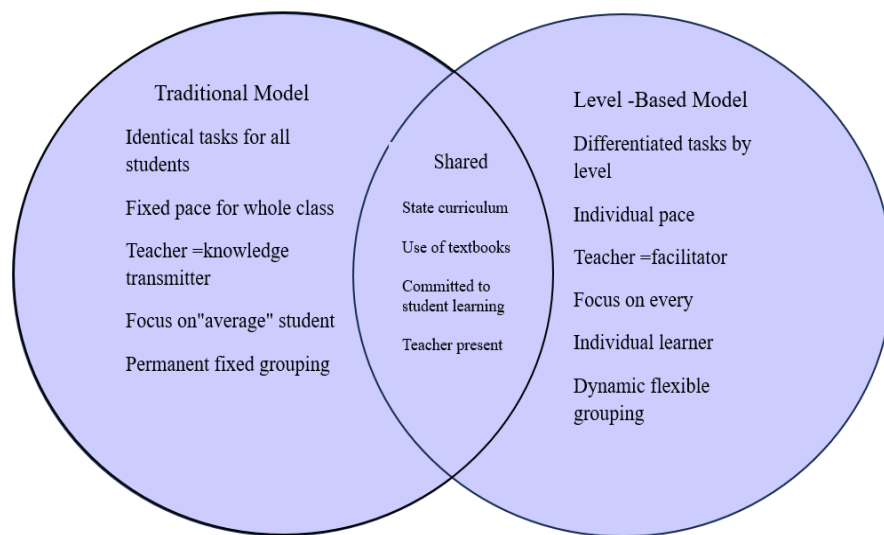


Figure 1.1 – Comparative Analysis: Traditional vs. Level-Based Teaching (Compiled by the author)

The distinction outlined above raises a fundamental methodological question: on what theoretical and technological basis can differentiated instruction be systematically organised and implemented? Answering this question requires an examination of the concept of pedagogical technology ,the framework within which differentiated instruction finds its most rigorous and reproducible form.

The term "technology" derives from the Greek "*techne*" (art, craft, skill) and "*logos*" (word, thought, doctrine). It entered the field of pedagogy in parallel with the development of industrial production, giving rise to the concept of pedagogical technology as a distinct area of scholarly inquiry.

According to Bespalko (1989, p. 5), the plans that teachers prepare : lesson plans, project lessons, experiments, and educational events already constitute a form of technology in the broad sense of the term. However, Bespalko (1989, p. 12) identifies four defining characteristics that distinguish pedagogical technology as a specific concept. First, it is built not on improvisation but on a deliberate, structured plan directed toward a predetermined outcome. Second, it is not merely a set of recommendations for the teacher, but a precise specification of student activity that guarantees successful results regardless of the individual personality of the educator. Third, goal-setting within pedagogical technology is a complete and rigorous process: goals must be measurable, specific, attainable, and verifiable. Fourth,

pedagogical technology is a system in which lessons are not scattered or arbitrary, but form a coherent and integrated mechanism.

Differentiated instruction meets all four of these criteria. First, the teacher cannot rely on improvisation: lessons must be continuously designed and tasks systematically prepared in advance. Second, differentiated instruction is precisely the kind of approach that places student activity at the centre of the learning process. Third, goal-setting is operationalised for each proficiency group through diagnostic criteria, ensuring that objectives are concrete and measurable for every learner. Fourth, differentiated instruction constitutes a whole system in which lessons are interconnected, student progress is continuously monitored, and through formative assessment the entire process develops in a spiral and cumulative fashion. Differentiated instruction may therefore be legitimately characterised as a pedagogical technology in the full and rigorous sense of the term.

Differentiated instruction is, however, a broad and multifaceted concept. When examined through the specific lens of proficiency-level variation, as is the case in the present study, several scholarly definitions prove particularly relevant.

Unt (1990, p. 4) defines differentiated instruction as a mode of organising the educational process that takes into account the typological individual characteristics of learners — their abilities, interests, inclinations, and level of achievement, so that every student may attain success. Polat (2002, p. 23) offers a definition specific to foreign language methodology, describing the differentiated approach as the organisation of learning activities built upon consideration of the individual psychological and educational characteristics of learners, aimed at the successful development of each student, the formation of general learning competencies, and the provision of opportunities for gifted learners to develop their abilities. Tomlinson (2001) approaches the concept philosophically, defining differentiated instruction as a philosophy of teaching based on the premise that teachers should adapt instruction to account for differences among students. Rather than adjusting students to fit the curriculum, teachers should proactively adjust the curriculum to fit the students

through the modification of content, process, and product on the basis of each student's readiness, interests, and learning profile.

A comparative analysis of these three definitions reveals a shared conceptual foundation: all authors agree that the educational process must be responsive to the individual and typological characteristics of learners. The definitions differ, however, in their emphases. Polat places particular stress on the development of gifted learners, underscoring that high-achieving students equally require dedicated pedagogical attention. Unt foregrounds the organisational dimension, highlighting the grouping of students as a structural prerequisite for effective differentiation. Tomlinson adopts the most expansive perspective, framing differentiation as a proactive educational philosophy rather than a reactive organisational measure. It should also be noted that the majority of existing definitions do not explicitly address the corrective dimension of differentiated instruction, that is, the targeted support required by learners who have not yet reached the expected proficiency threshold.

On the basis of the definitions examined above, the following working definition is proposed for the purposes of the present study: differentiated instruction is the organisation of the learning process that takes into account the individual and typological characteristics of learners, ensuring variable corrective and developmental trajectories for Grade 6 students in accordance with their starting level of English language proficiency. This definition is grounded in the goal of the present research, namely to evaluate the effectiveness of the differentiated approach as a means of correcting and developing basic speech skills. It is the contention of the present study that achieving programme-level language outcomes is most effectively accomplished through proactive pedagogical intervention, enabling a deeper and more individualised process of skill correction and transforming standard instruction into a conscious and purposeful development of communicative activity.

Having established the conceptual boundaries of differentiated instruction, it is now necessary to consider its structural organisation. Following Unt (1990, p. 16), differentiation may be divided into two principal types. External differentiation involves the organisational grouping of students into separate streams or classes on

the basis of interests, abilities, and learning styles, including the creation of specialised or profiled educational programmes. Internal or within-class differentiation, by contrast, occurs within a single class group, where tasks and learning conditions are adapted in accordance with the individual needs of each learner without altering the composition of the class itself. It is the latter form that is adopted in the present study, as it corresponds most closely to the organisational conditions of general secondary education in the Kyrgyz Republic and to the logic of the level-based model established in Section 1.1.

The classification of differentiated instruction as a pedagogical technology is most clearly evidenced by the framework proposed by Tomlinson (2001), which divides the instructional process into three fundamental components: content, process, and product. This structured approach transforms differentiation from a set of intuitive techniques into a systematic and reproducible model. The practical efficacy of this tripartite model in an EFL context has been demonstrated by Chien (2015, p. 283), whose study of mixed-level elementary English classes in Taiwan , a context that shares significant parallels with the multilingual and heterogeneous classrooms of Kyrgyzstan , confirms that differentiating along these three dimensions allows the teacher to address all proficiency levels simultaneously within a single class.

Within this technological framework, the three components are operationalised as follows. *Content differentiation* involves adapting the instructional material to meet learners' varying needs through the use of tiered texts, scaffolding, and varied linguistic supports, ensuring that the curriculum remains accessible to all proficiency levels. *Process differentiation* concerns the methods by which students make sense of ideas and information: it encompasses flexible grouping, tiered activities, and varied instructional tempos that allow learners to navigate content according to their individual cognitive styles and readiness. *Product differentiation*, finally, provides students with multiple ways to demonstrate their mastery of the material, including choice of format for the final task , allowing each learner to showcase their learning in a manner that aligns with their strengths

and proficiency level. As Chien (2015, p. 285) observes, these three components are deeply intertwined: the design of content, process, and product cannot be separated in practice, as each shapes and informs the others.

Despite its evident strengths, the practice of grouping students by level has not been without criticism in the scholarly literature. External differentiation in particular, the division of students into fixed streams or tracks, has been critiqued for its potential to stigmatise lower-achieving learners and reinforce educational inequality. Internal differentiation, however, is largely exempt from this criticism: because proficiency groups within a single class are flexible and temporary rather than permanent and institutional, they do not carry the social consequences associated with fixed-track systems. The empirical evidence supports this distinction: Smale-Jacobse et al. (2019, p.43) demonstrate, on the basis of a systematic review of research conducted between 2006 and 2016, that within-class differentiated instruction yields consistently positive effects on academic achievement in secondary education, with the most robust results recorded for tiered assignments and readiness-based grouping.

By anchoring the instructional design in the learner's current level of readiness operationalised in the present study through the CEFR proficiency scale, differentiated instruction ceases to be a mere organisational tool and becomes a rigorous pedagogical technology. It ensures that while the pathways through content, process, and product are diverse, the outcome remains focused on the successful development of each student's communicative potential within a unified educational system. The effective realisation of this technology at the level of the individual lesson, however, depends on a precise understanding of what is being developed that is, of the nature and structure of the basic speech skills that constitute the target of instruction in Grade 6 English. This question forms the subject of the following section.

1.3. Basic Speech Skills as a Foundation for Developing Students' Communicative Competence

The concept of basic speech skills occupies a central place in the theory and methodology of foreign language teaching. Despite varying terminological traditions across national and international scholarly schools, researchers consistently identify a core set of foundational competencies without which meaningful communicative activity remains unattainable. In order to establish a working definition suitable for the purposes of this study, it is necessary to examine how the concept of “basic speech skill” has been interpreted across key theoretical frameworks.

Passov (1991, p. 57) defines a speech skill as “the learner’s ability to perform a speech action according to optimal parameters , automaticity, consciousness, and pace which constitutes the foundation for mastering speech activity”. This definition emphasizes the dynamic, processual nature of skill development: a skill is not a static possession but an acquired capacity that must reach a level of automatization before it can serve as a reliable instrument of communication. Importantly, Passov situates the speech skill within the broader architecture of communicative methodology, treating it not as an end in itself but as a prerequisite for genuine speech performance.

A structurally more detailed account is offered by Gal’skova (2006, p. 57), who defines basic speech skills as “automatized components of conscious speech activity phonetic, lexical, and grammatical that ensure the production and comprehension of foreign language utterances across four primary domains: listening, speaking, reading, and writing”. This formulation is significant in two respects: first, it identifies the specific linguistic subsystems (phonology, vocabulary, grammar) that constitute the foundational layer of speech competence; second, it anchors these components within the four canonical modalities of language use, thereby establishing a structural correspondence between skill and activity type.

At the international level, the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) approaches the concept from a functional and pragmatic

perspective, defining basic skills referred to as *communicative language competence* as “a set of abilities enabling the learner to perform communicative tasks,” encompassing linguistic, sociolinguistic, and pragmatic competences (Council of Europe, 2001). Unlike the previous definitions, which foreground the psychological mechanism of skill formation, the CEFR shifts emphasis to the communicative outcome: skills are described in terms of what a learner *can do* with the language at a given level of proficiency.

A comparative analysis of these three definitions reveals both convergence and complementarity. All three frameworks concur that basic speech skills constitute a *foundation*, a prerequisite stratum upon which fuller communicative capacity is built. Passov foregrounds the developmental dynamics of skill acquisition; Gal'skova provides a componential taxonomy organized around the four speech activity domains; and the CEFR reframes skills as instruments of pragmatic accomplishment, oriented toward real-world communicative tasks. Together, these perspectives offer a comprehensive picture of what it means to possess basic speech skills in a foreign language.

For the purposes of the present study, the following working definition is proposed: *basic speech skills are understood as automatized components of speech primarily the lexico-grammatical base that constitute the foundation of communicative competence in Grade 6 learners and enable them to engage in communicative activity at a defined level of complexity.* This definition is grounded in the requirements of the State Educational Standard of the Kyrgyz Republic, which identifies communicative competence as the primary goal of English language instruction. Accordingly, basic speech skills are not themselves the terminal objective of teaching; rather, they represent the indispensable foundation upon which communicative competence is constructed and through which the prescribed educational outcomes can be achieved.

Having established that basic speech skills constitute the foundational stratum of communicative activity, it is now necessary to examine what communicative

competence itself entails , for it is precisely this construct that defines the ultimate goal toward which speech skill development is directed.

The concept of communicative competence has been subject to considerable theoretical debate since its introduction into linguistic scholarship. The earliest and most influential formulation of linguistic competence was proposed by Chomsky (1965, p. 74), who defined it as the native speaker's internalized knowledge of the grammatical rules of their language , the implicit system that enables the production and recognition of well-formed sentences. On this account, competence is essentially a cognitive and structural phenomenon: a speaker who has mastered the grammatical system of a language possesses, in principle, the generative capacity to produce an infinite range of correct utterances. Communicative success, from this perspective, follows naturally from grammatical knowledge.

However, this formulation was subsequently challenged as insufficient for describing real-world language use. Hymes (1972, p. 278) argued that grammatical knowledge alone does not account for the full range of abilities required for effective communication. A speaker may produce grammatically impeccable sentences that are nonetheless socially inappropriate, contextually mismatched, or communicatively ineffective. Hymes therefore proposed a broader conception of communicative competence, one that encompasses not only the knowledge of grammatical rules, but also the ability to use language appropriately in accordance with the social context, the communicative purpose, and the relationship between interlocutors. Competence, on this view, is inseparable from performance: it is the capacity to deploy linguistic resources effectively in situated, real-world communication.

For the purposes of the present study, the position of Hymes is adopted as the operative theoretical framework. This choice is not arbitrary , it is directly grounded in the requirements of the educational policy of the Kyrgyz Republic. The *State Educational Standard of School General Education of the Kyrgyz Republic* (Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic, 2025) defines the graduate outcome of school English language education in explicitly communicative

terms: the student must be able to communicate effectively and use the language appropriately across a range of real-life contexts. Grammatical knowledge, while necessary, is thus positioned as a means rather than an end. It is the Hymesian conception of communicative competence that oriented toward contextually appropriate, functionally effective language use that aligns with this policy mandate and informs the design of the level-based model developed in the present research.

Communicative competence, as defined by Hymes, is realized in practice through four types of speech activity, which constitute the primary domains of foreign language use: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

In the methodology of foreign language teaching, speech activity types are conventionally divided into two groups: *receptive skills* those through which the learner receives and processes linguistic input and *productive skills* those through which the learner generates language output. Table 1.5 presents this classification in consolidated form.

Table 1.5.

Classification of Speech Activity Types into Receptive and Productive Skills

Receptive Skills	Productive Skills
<i>(input – receiving language)</i>	<i>(output – producing language)</i>
Listening, Reading	Speaking, Writing

As illustrated in Table 1.5, listening belongs to the receptive group. According to Anderson and Lynch (1988, p. 5), listening is by no means a passive process; on the contrary, it constitutes an active and multi-layered cognitive activity. The authors identify four stages of the listening process which, crucially, do not occur sequentially but simultaneously – a fact which makes listening in a foreign language environment considerably more demanding than in one’s native tongue. These stages include: identifying speech sounds from surrounding noise; segmenting the continuous stream of speech into recognizable words; grasping the syntactic structure and meaning of the utterance; and formulating an appropriate response. It

is significant that this fourth stage already presupposes an immediate transition to the productive skill of speaking, thereby revealing the inherently interconnected nature of the four skill types: receptive and productive skills do not function in isolation but in continuous interaction.

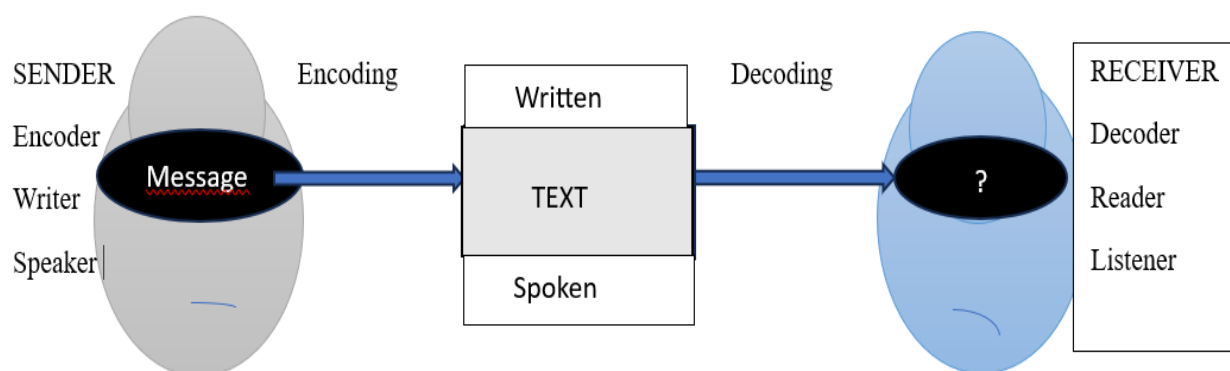
Turning to speaking as a productive skill, Bygate (1987, p. 5) notes that it demands automatized command of the language under real-time conditions. Unlike written communication, oral speech affords the speaker no opportunity to pause, reconsider, or revise what has been said. Speaking requires the simultaneous execution of thinking and language production – a considerable cognitive load that distinguishes it fundamentally from other modes of communication. Writing, by contrast, affords time for planning and editing, and is characterized by greater structural organization and formal precision.

Raimes (1983, p. 3) argues that writing supports language learning in three distinct ways: it reinforces the grammatical structures, idioms, and vocabulary that learners have been taught; it gives students the opportunity to be adventurous with the language, going beyond what they have already mastered; and it engages the learner deeply through the unique relationship between thinking and writing. Furthermore, Raimes (1983, p. 4) identifies fundamental differences between speaking and writing as modes of communication: speaking is spontaneous and informal, while writing is planned and structurally organized; the speaker relies on intonation, rhythm, and gesture to convey meaning, whereas the writer has only the words on the page; and while speaking involves immediate feedback from an interlocutor, writing offers no such real-time response.

Having examined three of the four skill types, we turn finally to reading as a receptive skill. Nuttall (1996, p. 3) proposes three approaches to defining what reading entails. The first defines reading as the recognition of written words, as a skill that is undeniably important, particularly for beginning learners, but insufficient as a complete account of the reading process. The second approach treats reading as the oral rendering of text as a skill relevant at early stages of literacy development, but not central to mature reading comprehension. The third approach, which Nuttall

identifies as central, defines reading as the extraction and construction of meaning from text: true reading is neither mere word recognition nor oral performance, but an active process of meaning-making.

Nuttall (1996, p. 4) further observes that reading aloud establishes a direct connection between written text and oral speech, thereby revealing the interdependence of the four skill types. This interconnection is captured schematically in Figure 1.2, which illustrates the fundamental structure of any communicative act.



[Figure 1.2. The Communication Process (Source: Nuttall, C. (1996). Teaching Reading Skills in a Foreign Language. Heinemann, p. 4)]

As Figure 1.2 demonstrates, every act of communication involves two roles: sender and receiver ; and two channels : spoken and written. The sender encodes a message through speaking or writing; the receiver decodes it through listening or reading. All four types of speech activity are thus present within a single communicative event, each performing an indispensable function. No channel can be removed without disrupting the communicative process as a whole.

It follows, therefore, that communicative competence is understood in the Hymesian sense as the ability to use language effectively and appropriately in context cannot be achieved through the development of any single skill in isolation. It is precisely the integrated mastery of all four types of speech activity, grounded in automatized basic speech skills, that enables the learner to function as a full participant in communicative interaction. Basic speech skills ,the lexico-grammatical foundation established at the outset of the present section ,thus serve

not merely as a technical prerequisite, but as the indispensable basis upon which genuine communicative competence is constructed.

Having established that the four types of speech activity are functionally interconnected, it is equally important to recognize that the process of skill formation varies considerably across individuals and age groups. The present section examines how this process unfolds specifically in Grade 6 learners – students aged 11 to 12 in the context of foreign language acquisition.

As Leontiev (1977, p. 47) observes, this developmental period is characterized by a pronounced intensification of social interaction: children at this stage increasingly seek communication with peers and become acutely sensitive to the evaluative responses of those around them. This heightened social awareness has direct implications for foreign language learning. In line with this observation, Zimnyaya (2004, p. 83) argues that language acquisition at this age is inseparably linked to the learner's emotional state: the affective dimension of learning is not peripheral but constitutive of the learning process itself. When learners feel emotionally secure, their capacity for language production expands; when they do not, it contracts.

This emotional vulnerability manifests most acutely in oral performance. Students of this age tend to fear making mistakes in front of their peers to a greater degree than in written tasks, and this fear produces a measurable inhibitory effect on the development of productive speech skills – speaking in particular. In the scholarly literature, this psychological phenomenon is defined by Horwitz, Horwitz et al. (1986, p. 128) as *foreign language anxiety* – “a distinct complex of self-perceptions, beliefs, feelings, and behaviours related to classroom language learning arising from the uniqueness of the language learning process”. Within a differentiated teaching model, this challenge is addressed through the organization of level-based tasks and the formation of groups that are homogeneous in terms of proficiency, thereby creating a psychologically safer environment in which learners at similar levels are more willing to take communicative risks.

This situation acquires particular significance in the educational context of the Kyrgyz Republic, where English is studied not as a second language but as a third language (L3) – following Kyrgyz and Russian as the primary languages of instruction and daily communication. As Cummins (2000, p. 233) demonstrates, the acquisition of a third language is considerably more complex than the acquisition of a second, given the compounding effects of cross-linguistic interference from two previously acquired systems. In the case of Kyrgyzstani learners, this complexity is further amplified by the typological distance between the three languages involved: Kyrgyz belongs to the Turkic language family, Russian to the Slavic branch of Indo-European, and English to the Germanic branch – three structurally and grammatically distinct systems whose simultaneous influence on the learner's interlanguage makes the development of basic speech skills a particularly demanding pedagogical task. It is precisely this multilingual reality that renders level-based differentiation not merely a methodological preference, but a pedagogical necessity.

The analysis conducted in the present section leads to a number of conclusions of theoretical and methodological significance. Basic speech skills understood as automatized lexico-grammatical components of speech activity constitute the indispensable foundation upon which communicative competence is built. As demonstrated through the positions of Passov, Gal'skova, and the CEFR, these skills are not ends in themselves but prerequisite instruments of communicative performance, encompassing all four domains of speech activity: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

The adoption of Hymes' conception of communicative competence as the ability to use language appropriately in real-world contexts as the operative theoretical framework of the present study reflects both the demands of contemporary linguistic theory and the requirements of the State Educational Standard of the Kyrgyz Republic. The four speech activity types, far from being independent skills, form an integrated communicative system in which each component supports and reinforces the others.

The age-related and sociolinguistic characteristics of Grade 6 learners including heightened social sensitivity, susceptibility to foreign language anxiety, and the complexity of acquiring English as a third language in a multilingual context further underscore the necessity of a differentiated approach to the development of basic speech skills. These considerations provide the theoretical basis for the level-based model examined in the sections that follow. The specific theoretical and methodological approaches to organizing level-based differentiation in English language teaching are addressed in Section 1.4.

1.4. Theoretical and Methodological Approaches to Organizing Level-Based Differentiation in English Language Teaching

As established in Sections 1.1 through 1.3, level-based differentiation constitutes a pedagogical strategy designed to ensure unified educational outcomes while simultaneously accommodating the individual language proficiency of each learner. However, for this strategy to function as a coherent system rather than a collection of isolated methodological techniques, it must be grounded in a principled theoretical and methodological foundation. The present section examines the key theoretical approaches that define the internal logic of the level-based model implemented in this study.

The theoretical point of departure for the model is the student-centred approach, which establishes its axiological that is, its value foundation. It is of fundamental importance to emphasise that the organisation of level-based differentiation is premised not on an assessment of the learner's innate abilities, but on their actual level of language preparedness at a given moment in the instructional process. According to Bakhriddinov et al. (2017, p.87), the student-centred approach must be harmoniously integrated with the principles of humanism in education, creating conditions for the realisation of each learner's individual potential. This approach serves as an impetus for the formation and development of each student as a unique and self-sufficient individual.

In accordance with the methodological guidelines on student-centred instruction developed by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic with the support of USAID (2015, p. 6), the successful implementation of individualisation requires a fundamental transformation of the teacher's role from instructor to facilitator. Within this paradigm, the educational process is constructed on the recognition that each learner is a unique individual, possessed of their own goals, interests, and personal characteristics. Consequently, the organisation of instruction must be of a differentiated character, adapting where necessary to the individual needs of each student. It is on this basis that the student-centred approach in contemporary language didactics is operationalised through the instrument of level-based differentiation. A closely aligned position is advanced by Tomlinson (2001, p.2), who conceptualises differentiation as a system in which tasks are designed not according to a uniform template, but in response to the subjective experience of each individual learner. The student-centred approach thus constitutes the axiological foundation of the model it answers the question: *who is the subject of learning?*

The recognition of each learner's uniqueness must be translated into concrete instructional activity and it is here that the systemic-activity approach becomes indispensable, transforming the principles of student-centredness into the practical design of learning tasks. As Ilyina and Evstigneeva observe (2020, p.200), the systemic-activity approach accounts for the transition from passive knowledge acquisition to the active solution of communicative tasks. Applied to level-based differentiation, this means that the instructional process is organised in accordance with the specific activity profile of each learner group: tasks are designed to correspond to the group's current level of competence while simultaneously creating conditions for its development.

Contemporary international research extends this framework further: Hendel (2020, p.87) examines level-based differentiation within the concept of Universal Design for Learning, in which an inclusive educational environment is constructed from the outset ensuring equitable access to quality instruction for all categories of

learners through a systemic-activity framework. The systemic-activity approach thus constitutes the technological instrument of the model it answers the question: *how is learning carried out?*

Insofar as the model is concerned with development, it is necessary to integrate into the differentiation framework the concept of the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), proposed by Vygotsky (1978, p.382). Within the level-based model, tasks are designed to create a condition of intellectual tension advancing the learner's skills from the zone of potential capacity to the zone of actual competence. Proficiency groups, accordingly, are not fixed or permanent: as a learner masters the competencies of their current level, they are expected to transition to the next and it is precisely in this way that the principle of dynamism is realised in practice.

In order for level-based tasks to be not arbitrary but objectively justified, a unified measurement instrument is required. In the system of level-based differentiation, this instrument is provided by the descriptors of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) (2001). Within this system, the CEFR performs two essential functions: first, a *diagnostic* function enabling the teacher to identify each learner's current competence profile with precision; and second, a *goal-setting* function whereby the attainment of a specific descriptor becomes the operational learning objective around which differentiated tasks are designed.

However, macro-level descriptor formulations are necessarily broad in character and cannot directly guide the learner's activity within the context of a specific lesson. The key methodological task, therefore, is the micro-level operationalisation of the descriptor its systematic elaboration into a sequence of specific, progressively complex learning outcomes aligned to a particular topic. As Vanyagina observes (2025, p.168), descriptors are variable constructs that must be elaborated into smaller, granular outcomes transforming an abstract goal into a practical instrument for lesson delivery. Table 1.6 illustrates this mechanism through a Grade 6 task on the topic of "Weather."

Table 1.6.

Operationalisation of CEFR Descriptors: Task Example on the Topic “Weather”

(Compiled by the author)

Stage	Descriptor
Lexical	I can name at least 4 topic-specific words related to "Weather": sun, rain, cold, windy.
Grammatical	I can construct impersonal sentences of the type "It is...": It is sunny. It is snowing.
Elaboration	I can describe additional features (sky or temperature): The sky is blue. The sun is bright.
Coherence	I can express whether I like this weather and explain why: I like it because I can go for a walk.

The descriptor thus functions not only as an instrument of goal-setting — translating the standard into an accessible lesson objective, but also as the criterial foundation for objective assessment and the correction of the educational process, ensuring a gradual transition from reproductive to productive levels of foreign language communication. The ZPD and CEFR descriptors together answer the question: *where is learning directed?*

The Five Principles of the Level-Based Model: Theoretical Grounding

The synthesis of the theoretical approaches examined above is embodied in five interrelated pedagogical principles that collectively define the theoretical logic of the level-based model and distinguish it from traditional approaches to instruction. Table 1.7 presents these principles in consolidated form.

Table 1.7.

Five Pedagogical Principles of the Level-Based Teaching Model: Theoretical Grounding and Practical Implications

(Compiled by the author)

Principle	Theoretical basis	Practical implication	Key scholar(s)
1. Individualization	Personality-centred learning; learner as carrier of subjective experience	Tasks build on each student's existing knowledge and cognitive profile	Yakimanskaya (1996); Tomlinson (2001)
2. Dynamism	Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD): growth occurs at the boundary of current capacity	Proficiency groups are flexible; students advance as competence develops	Vygotsky (1978, p. 382)
3. Unity of Goals	State educational standards mandate unified outcomes for all students	All groups share one communicative objective; pathways and complexity differ	Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic (2025, p. 15)
4. Accessibility	"i+1" hypothesis: optimal input is comprehensible yet slightly beyond current level	Every learner experiences a "situation of success"; tasks are attainable yet demanding	Krashen (1982, p. 19)
5. Progressive Complexity	Bloom's Taxonomy: hierarchical progression from knowledge to evaluation	Tasks calibrated to Bloom's levels per proficiency group; no cognitive ceiling imposed	Bloom et al. (1956)

The ***first principle*** is the principle of *individualisation*. It proceeds from the recognition that each learner arrives in the classroom as a unique individual – a carrier of subjective experience, in the terminology of Yakimanskaya (1996, p.9), whose concept of personality-centred learning identifies three defining characteristics of individuality: the selectivity of cognition, the stable emotional relationship the learner forms with the objects of knowledge, and the pre-existing

reservoir of personal meaning that precedes any formal educational encounter. Within the level-based model, this principle is realised by positioning tasks not at the curriculum in general, but at the individual learner – beginning from their subjective experience, as Tomlinson (2014, p.2) similarly advocates.

The ***second principle*** is the principle of *dynamism*. Level-based proficiency groups are not permanent or fixed categories. Placement reflects the learner's current state of linguistic readiness, not a static label. This principle finds its theoretical grounding in Vygotsky's concept of the Zone of Proximal Development (1978, p.382): genuine learning occurs precisely within this zone, when a task is positioned just beyond the learner's independent capacity, thereby creating conditions for intellectual growth. As learners master the competencies of their current level, they are expected to transition to the next group.

The ***third principle*** is the principle of *unity of goals*. As stipulated by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic (2022, p. 15), all Grade 6 learners must attain the A2+ CEFR level regardless of their starting point. The level-based model does not contradict this requirement, it is built upon it. All groups share the same communicative objective; what differs is the pathway and the level of complexity through which each group reaches it.

The ***fourth principle*** is the principle of *accessibility*. Every learner must experience a "situation of success", a moment of genuine achievement that confirms their capacity to progress and sustains motivation. This principle is theoretically anchored in Krashen's "i+1" hypothesis (1982, p.19): "effective acquisition occurs when input is comprehensible yet slightly beyond the learner's current competence". A task too far beyond the learner's level produces anxiety and disengagement; one that merely reproduces what the learner already knows offers no developmental value.

The ***fifth principle*** is the principle of *progressive complexity*. No learner regardless of starting level is expected to remain at the same cognitive level indefinitely. The theoretical basis for this principle is Bloom's Taxonomy of Educational Objectives (1956), which proposes a hierarchical model of cognitive

complexity comprising six levels: knowledge, comprehension, application, analysis, synthesis, and evaluation. Within the level-based model, Bloom's Taxonomy serves as the primary instrument for calibrating task complexity across proficiency groups: foundational-group students engage primarily with knowledge and comprehension tasks; as they progress, tasks demand application and analysis; advanced-group students operate at the highest levels synthesis and evaluation producing original, critically reflective language use.

Taken together, these five principles distinguish the level-based model from a mere organisational technique and establish it as a comprehensive, theoretically grounded pedagogical strategy one that is simultaneously responsive to individual learner needs and aligned with the unified requirements of the state educational standard.

The Hierarchical Structure of the Theoretical and Methodological Foundations of the Model.

The synthesis of the approaches examined above makes it possible to construct a hierarchical model of the methodological foundations of the proposed instructional strategy, as represented in Figure 1.3.

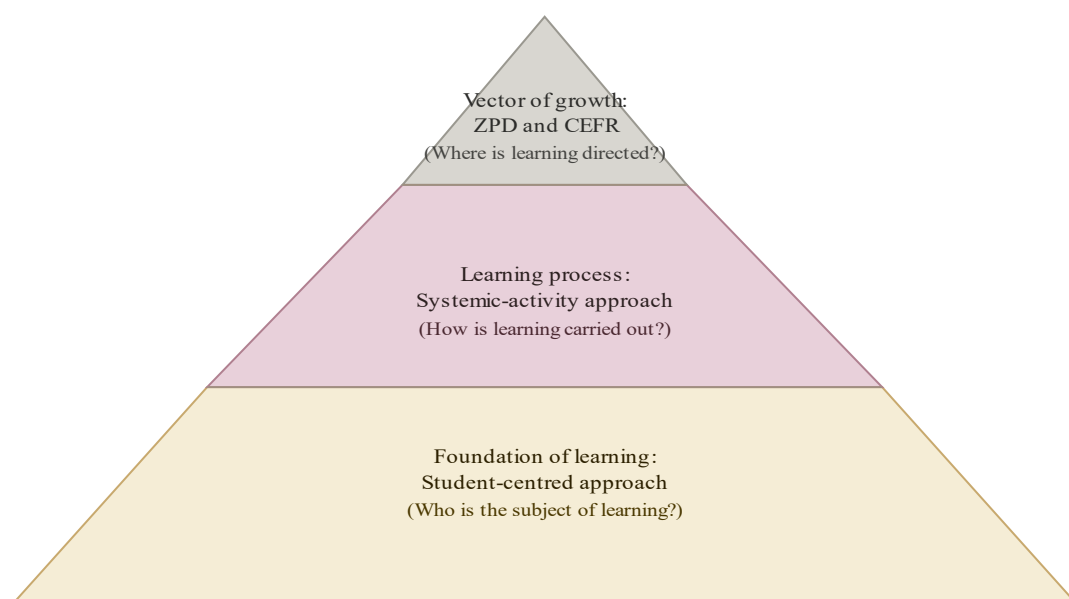


Figure 1.3. Hierarchical Model of the Theoretical and Methodological Foundations of Level-Based Differentiation

(Compiled by the author)

The hierarchy presented in Figure 1.3 reflects the systemic relationship between three levels of methodological grounding. At the **axiological level** – the foundation that stands the student-centred approach, which establishes the humanistic orientation of differentiation: the central value is the uniqueness of each learner and their right to an individual developmental trajectory. At the **technological level** – the process that stands the systemic-activity approach, through which specific learning actions and tasks are designed and the teacher’s role is transformed into that of a facilitator. At the **prognostic level** – the vector of growth stand the concept of the ZPD and the CEFR descriptors, which together define the specific trajectory of the learner’s movement from the zone of proximal development toward the level of actual competence. The descriptors function as a navigator, translating state educational standards at the macro-level into measurable lesson outcomes at the micro-level.

The theoretical and methodological analysis conducted in the present section leads to the conclusion that level-based differentiation in English language teaching constitutes not a methodological technique but a pedagogical strategy requiring a

principled theoretical foundation. The integration of the student-centred and systemic-activity approaches with the concept of the Zone of Proximal Development and the descriptors of the CEFR produces a coherent model in which each approach fulfils a distinct function: the first establishes the value foundation of differentiation, the second defines the logic of task design, and the third provides the vector of learner development.

Conclusions for Chapter I

The theoretical and methodological analysis conducted in Chapter 1 establishes the conceptual foundations upon which the level-based teaching model developed in the present research is built. The findings of the chapter may be summarised across four interrelated domains.

First, the examination of language proficiency levels and the CEFR framework demonstrates that the six-level scale provides the most precise and internationally recognised instrument for identifying, describing, and targeting learner competence. In the multilingual educational context of the Kyrgyz Republic, where English functions as a third language following Kyrgyz and Russian, significant heterogeneity in proficiency within a single class is a structural rather than an exceptional condition. The *Subject Standard 'English Language' for Grades 5 to 11* (2022, p. 15) mandates unified A2+ outcomes for Grade 6, establishing the CEFR as both a diagnostic tool and a goal-setting instrument for the level-based model.

Second, the analysis of differentiated instruction as a pedagogical technology confirms that it satisfies all four criteria proposed by Bespalko (1989, p. 12): deliberate planning directed toward a predetermined outcome, precise specification of student activity, rigorous and measurable goal-setting, and systemic interconnection of lessons. Differentiation operates through three complementary components identified by Tomlinson (2001) as content, process, and product, and the empirical evidence reviewed by Smale-Jacobse et al. (2019, p. 43) confirms that within-class differentiated instruction consistently produces positive effects on academic achievement in secondary education.

Third, the examination of basic speech skills as the foundation of communicative competence reveals that automatised lexico-grammatical components of speech activity underlie all four domains of language use: listening, speaking, reading, and writing. The functional interdependence of these four skill types, illustrated through the positions of Passov (1991, p. 57), Gal'skova and Gez (2006, p. 57), and the CEFR (Council of Europe, 2001, p. 13), means that communicative competence cannot be developed through isolated skill training but requires an integrated instructional approach. The adoption of Hymes' (1972) conception of communicative competence as the operative theoretical framework aligns with the policy mandate of the State Educational Standard of the Kyrgyz Republic (Ministry of Education and Science of the Kyrgyz Republic, 2014), which positions communicative ability as the terminal goal of English language education.

Fourth, the theoretical and methodological foundations of the level-based model are established through the integration of three complementary approaches. The student-centred approach provides the axiological foundation of the model, foregrounding the uniqueness of each learner and their right to an individual developmental trajectory. The systemic-activity approach defines the technological logic of task design, ensuring the transition from passive knowledge reception to active communicative problem-solving. The concept of the Zone of Proximal Development proposed by Vygotsky (1978, p. 382), together with the operationalised CEFR descriptors, provides the prognostic vector: tasks are calibrated to advance each learner from their current level of competence toward the next, guided by the five pedagogical principles of individualisation, dynamism, unity of goals, accessibility, and progressive complexity.

In sum, the theoretical framework elaborated in Chapter I demonstrates that level-based differentiation is not a collection of isolated methodological techniques but a coherent pedagogical strategy grounded in established theory and aligned with the educational standards of the Kyrgyz Republic. The findings of this chapter provide the conceptual basis for the design and implementation of the level-based

instructional model, the practical dimensions of which are examined in the chapters that follow.

CHAPTER II. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1. Object, Subject and Methods of the Research

The object of the research is the process of English language teaching in a Grade 6 classroom within a rural multilingual school setting. This process exists independently of the researcher and gives rise to a specific pedagogical problem: the pronounced heterogeneity of students' language proficiency levels within a single classroom renders a uniform, undifferentiated instructional approach ineffective as a means of ensuring that all learners achieve the mandatory state educational standards. In the sociolinguistic context of a rural school in the Kyrgyz Republic, where English is perceived by the majority of students as a third language (L3) following Kyrgyz and Russian, this problem is compounded by the significant linguistic distance between the target language and the learners' primary languages, as well as by the limited instructional time allocated to English at the lower secondary level.

The subject of the research is the level-based model of differentiated instruction as a means of developing the foundational speech skills and communicative competence of Grade 6 students with heterogeneous language proficiency profiles, in accordance with the requirements of the state educational standard. The subject encompasses the following properties and relationships of the object: the structural principles underlying the level-based differentiated model; the design and content of differentiated lesson tasks for each proficiency level; the influence of the level-based approach on the dynamics of students' language progress and motivational engagement; and the pedagogical conditions that determine the effectiveness of the model in a rural multilingual instructional context. The concept of the "situation of success" (as discussed in Chapter I) constitutes a foundational theoretical premise informing the design of the subject: the model is constructed so that each student, regardless of proficiency level, is provided with conditions under which meaningful task completion and a sense of academic achievement are attainable.

To address the research objectives, a mixed-methods approach was employed, combining theoretical and empirical methods. This approach was selected because quantitative data derived from standardized testing and qualitative data obtained through observation and self-assessment instruments are mutually complementary, providing a multi-dimensional account of the pedagogical effects of the level-based model on both academic outcomes and the motivational sphere of the learners.

The theoretical methods applied in this study are as follows. The analysis and synthesis of scientific literature on differentiated instruction, level-based differentiation, communicative competence, and the development of foundational speech skills were conducted to establish the conceptual and terminological framework of the research (see Chapter I). Comparative analysis was employed to examine existing approaches to organizing level-based differentiation in foreign language teaching and to contrast differentiated instruction with the traditional undifferentiated method, thereby providing a theoretical justification for the pedagogical model developed in the present study. Generalization and systematization of pedagogical approaches were used to formulate the principles of the level-based model and to substantiate the selection of instructional methods appropriate to each proficiency group.

The empirical methods applied in this study are as follows. A pedagogical experiment constituted the primary empirical method of the research, enabling a direct verification of the effectiveness of the level-based differentiated model under authentic classroom conditions. The experiment was conducted in the absence of a control group; accordingly, the within-group comparison of pre-test and post-test results served as the primary basis for evaluating the model's impact. Standardized proficiency testing was employed at the diagnostic stage (pre-test, January 2026) and at the summative stage (post-test, March 2026). Both assessment instruments were designed on a 100-point scale and based on the tasks of the "Take Off with English" educational-methodical complex, ensuring contextual validity and consistency with the curriculum studied by the participants. Systematic pedagogical observation was conducted throughout the formative stage by means of Instructional

Monitoring Protocols, which served as a longitudinal record of each student's task engagement, scaffolding utilization, and individual behavioral dynamics across all 16 lessons. Learner self-assessment was implemented through Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets administered upon the completion of each thematic unit. These instruments were calibrated to the proficiency level of each group and were designed to gather qualitative feedback on the accessibility of the provided instructional supports, the degree of task completion, and the learners' perceived sense of academic success. Audio recording of students' oral responses at both the diagnostic and summative assessment stages provided a verifiable dataset for the longitudinal analysis of phonetic, lexical, and fluency development.

The quantitative data obtained through the pre-test and post-test assessments were processed using descriptive statistical methods, including: calculation of the individual score gain for each participant; computation of the mean score for the whole class and for each proficiency group; calculation of the relative growth for each assessed skill component, expressed as a percentage of the maximum possible score per section; and comparative analysis of pre-test and post-test results across groups and skill domains.

The reliability and validity of the research findings are ensured through the triangulation of three independent data sources: the quantitative results of standardized testing, the qualitative entries of the Instructional Monitoring Protocols, and the data of the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets. The convergence of conclusions drawn from these three sources provides substantive evidence for the validity of the findings and confirms that the observed improvements in student performance reflect genuine pedagogical progress attributable to the level-based differentiated model.

2.2. Organization of the Pedagogical Experiment

The empirical phase of the research was conducted at the "Amanat" secondary school, located in Oktyabr village, Alamudun district, Chuy region, Kyrgyz Republic. The pedagogical experiment was carried out from January to March 2026.

The study sample comprised 24 sixth-grade students who participated in the testing and implementation of the level-based differentiated model.

The selection of this experimental setting and participant group was informed by the following methodological considerations. First, the researcher's role as a faculty member at "Amanat" school ensured the necessary conditions for continuous participant observation and consistent monitoring of experimental outcomes. In addition, the researcher had been providing English instruction to this particular cohort since Grade 5, which afforded a comprehensive understanding of the students' developmental trajectories and individual learning profiles. Second, the sixth grade was selected on account of the marked disparities in English language proficiency among the students: while some learners successfully met the requirements of the standard curriculum, others encountered the material as either excessively demanding or insufficiently challenging. This heterogeneity within a single classroom highlighted the pedagogical necessity of a level-based differentiated approach as a means of ensuring that all students could achieve the mandatory state educational standards.

The study was conducted in a rural sociolinguistic environment where Kyrgyz serves as the primary language of instruction and social communication. This context necessitated a tailored pedagogical approach, as English is perceived by the learners not only as a foreign language but often as a third language (L3), following Kyrgyz and Russian. The instructional frequency for this cohort varied across the lower secondary levels: in Grade 5, English was taught three times per week, whereas in Grade 6 the curriculum allocated two lessons per week. This reduction in instructional time further justified the implementation of a more efficient, differentiated teaching model to maintain learning momentum.

A critical factor in the experimental design was the baseline proficiency of the students. Upon entering Grade 5, an initial assessment revealed that 50% of the students lacked basic alphabetical literacy, demonstrating no prior recognition of English letters or phonetic awareness. Consequently, a foundational intervention phase was implemented, focused on: establishing grapho-phonemic awareness

(alphabetical recognition); developing decoding skills (basic reading and pronunciation rules); and bridging the significant literacy gap to prepare students for the standardized curriculum.

The subsequent teaching process during the experiment was systematically aligned with the "Take Off with English" educational-methodical complex (EMC) by Marshall Cavendish Education. The communicative orientation and modular structure of this curriculum provided a framework for the adaptation of exercises to address persisting achievement gaps – through scaffolded materials for students with basic literacy difficulties and enriched content for those meeting the age-appropriate standards.

The primary aim of the experiment was to evaluate the effectiveness of the level-based model of differentiated English language instruction for Grade 6 students as a strategic tool for correcting and developing fundamental communicative and linguistic skills. To achieve this aim, the following research objectives were established:

1. Initial Diagnostic Assessment: to conduct a comprehensive pre-test to determine the baseline English proficiency levels of the students and identify specific learning gaps.
2. Strategic Grouping: to categorize the study participants into differentiated learning groups based on the diagnostic results, ensuring that instruction was tailored to their current cognitive and linguistic capacities.
3. Methodological Adaptation of the EMC: to design and integrate level-based differentiated tasks and instructional materials derived from the "Take Off with English" (TOWE) curriculum.
4. Implementation and Observation: to pilot the developed model over the experimental period while performing systematic participant observation to monitor student engagement and progress.
5. Comparative Progress Evaluation: to administer a final post-test and conduct a comparative analysis of the data to verify the efficiency of the level-based differentiated approach in achieving the mandatory educational standards.

To ensure a comprehensive analysis of the model's effectiveness, a mixed-methods approach was employed, integrating both quantitative and qualitative data collection. The following instruments were utilized during the experimental period.

1. Standardized Proficiency Testing (Pre-Test and Post-Test)

The primary quantitative data were gathered through diagnostic (pre-test) and evaluative (post-test) assessments. The tests were designed on a 100-point scale and covered four fundamental language skills: Listening, Reading, Writing, and Speaking. This holistic approach aligns with the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) and is directed toward the development of communicative competence. The structure of the assessment instruments is presented in Table 2.1.

Table 2.1.

Structure of the Diagnostic and Summative Tests

Nº	Section	Instrument	Skill	Max. Score
1	Speaking	Monologue (25 pts) + Dialogue (25 pts)	Oral	50
2	Writing	Written text (5–8 sentences)	Written	15
3	Use of English	Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading (TOWE tasks)	Written	20
4	Listening	Audio tracks from the TOWE curriculum	Aural	15
	TOTAL			100

The assessment materials were derived directly from the TOWE curriculum to ensure contextual validity: the use of familiar task formats allowed students to demonstrate their actual linguistic abilities without the confounding effect of unfamiliar testing structures. The full scoring rubrics are presented in Appendix 1.

2. Instructional Monitoring Protocols

To track the implementation of the differentiated model on a systematic basis, Instructional Monitoring Protocols (IMPs) were maintained throughout the formative stage. Completed during every lesson, these protocols served as a longitudinal record of classroom dynamics, documenting: the student's assigned level and group; the nature and complexity of the differentiated tasks; the utilization

and effectiveness of instructional scaffolds; and individual student progress and behavioral dynamics (see Appendix 2).

3. Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets

Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets were administered upon the completion of each thematic unit. The sheets were tailored to the proficiency level of each group, ensuring that the language of reflection was accessible to all participants. Their purpose was to monitor the students' affective state and to gather feedback on the utility of the provided instructional supports, thereby allowing an evaluation of whether the level-based differentiation effectively reduced learning barriers and increased student confidence (see Appendix 3).

4. Data Analysis

The collected data underwent comparative analysis. Quantitative results from the 100-point assessments were used to measure statistical growth, while qualitative data from the monitoring protocols and self-assessment sheets provided insight into the pedagogical conditions that facilitated this progress.

2.3. Stages of the Pedagogical Experiment

Stages of the Diagnostic Phase

The diagnostic phase was conducted over three consecutive 45-minute sessions in January 2026. All assessments were performed during regular English lessons to maintain a natural educational environment and minimize student anxiety.

Stage 1: Assessment of Written and Receptive Skills (January 12)

The diagnostic process commenced with a standardized written examination covering Vocabulary, Reading, Grammar, and Writing. A strict time limit was applied to each component: Vocabulary – 7 minutes; Reading – 15 minutes; Grammar – 7 minutes; Writing – 13 minutes. This structured approach allowed the evaluation of students' ability to mobilize their linguistic knowledge under time-constrained conditions, mirroring standardized testing protocols.

Stage 2: Evaluation of Aural and Oral Competencies (January 13)

The second session was dedicated to assessing communicative skills through Listening and Speaking modules. The Listening task was administered collectively

to the entire class, while Speaking was evaluated individually through monologues and dialogues. All oral responses were audio-recorded to provide a verifiable dataset for subsequent phonetic and lexical analysis.

Stage 3: Data Analysis and Strategic Grouping (January 14)

The final diagnostic session involved the comprehensive analysis of accumulated data. Through the triangulation of results across all six tested components, systemic and individual learning gaps were identified, students were distributed into proficiency-based groups, and an initial series of differentiated lesson plans was designed.

2.3.1. Phases of the Formative Stage

The formative stage was conducted from January 19 to March 16, 2026, comprising 16 instructional sessions over an eight-week active teaching period (two lessons per week), with one week of scheduled recess (March 2–6). All lessons were delivered in accordance with the existing school curriculum, using the TOWE textbook as the primary instructional resource. A standard classroom seating arrangement was maintained throughout the experiment to prevent ability labeling or stigmatization; students were not physically separated into groups, and differentiated materials were distributed discreetly.

The formative process was structured into four distinct operational phases. During the Initial Phase (Weeks 1–2: Acclimatization), the primary focus was on familiarizing students with the system of differentiated instruction. Particular attention was devoted to Group 1, whose students required additional support to develop the habit of working with instructional scaffolds such as substitution tables and vocabulary prompts. Instructional monitoring protocols were initiated from the first lesson.

During the Active Phase (Weeks 3–5: Implementation and Monitoring), the focus shifted to systematic observation of how students in Groups 1 and 2 engaged with and utilized the provided scaffolds. Self-assessment sheets were administered following key thematic units to gather qualitative data on student confidence and perceived utility of the instructional supports.

The Developmental Phase (Weeks 6–7: Progressive Complexity) involved a gradual increase in the cognitive demand of differentiated tasks, reflecting a deliberate shift from controlled activities toward greater learner autonomy. Instances of upward level transition – cases in which individual students successfully completed tasks designed for a higher proficiency level than their original assignment – were documented in the dynamic progress section of the IMPs.

During the Concluding Phase (Week 8: Synthesis and Consolidation), all observational data were consolidated. Instructional monitoring protocols and self-assessment sheets were completed in full, providing a comprehensive longitudinal record of each student's engagement and progress throughout the experiment.

The Control Stage: Summative Assessment and Comparative Analysis

The Control Stage was conducted upon the completion of the eight-week formative period. Its primary objective was to determine the extent of progress in the students' English language proficiency and to evaluate the overall effectiveness of the level-based differentiated model. To ensure comparative validity, the post-test was designed to mirror the structure and complexity of the diagnostic pre-test, utilizing a 100-point scale across the same four domains of communicative competence (see Appendix 4).

The summative assessment process was guided by four research tasks: quantitative evaluation of changes in linguistic performance; qualitative documentation of oral responses for longitudinal comparison; comparative analysis of pre-test and post-test scores to identify statistical and pedagogical growth; and efficiency verification through synthesis of findings in relation to the mandatory educational standards.

The control stage was conducted on March 23–24, 2026. Written components (Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading, Writing) were administered on March 23; aural and oral skills were assessed on March 24. Consistent with the diagnostic phase, all oral performances were audio-recorded. By maintaining identical testing parameters including venue, duration, and task formats extraneous variables were eliminated,

ensuring that observed improvements could be attributed to the differentiated instructional interventions.

Thus, the pedagogical experiment was structured as a coherent three-stage process encompassing diagnostic, formative, and summative phases. The triangulation of quantitative and qualitative instruments: standardized testing, instructional monitoring protocols, and differentiated self-assessment sheets ensured the comprehensiveness and objectivity of the findings. The following section presents the content and practical implementation of the level-based differentiated model applied during the formative stage.

Conclusions for Chapter II

Chapter II established the methodological foundation of the present research. The object of the research is the process of English language teaching in a Grade 6 classroom of a rural multilingual school, and the subject is the level-based model of differentiated instruction as a means of correcting and developing the foundational speech skills of learners with heterogeneous proficiency profiles.

A mixed-methods approach was selected as the most appropriate research design, combining standardised proficiency testing, Instructional Monitoring Protocols, and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets. The integration of quantitative and qualitative instruments ensures that both the academic outcomes and the motivational dynamics of the participants are captured comprehensively, while the triangulation of three independent data sources provides the methodological basis for the validity and reliability of the findings.

The pedagogical experiment was conducted at the "Amanat" Secondary School from January to March 2026 with a sample of 24 Grade 6 students. The experimental setting was selected on account of the pronounced proficiency heterogeneity of the cohort and the rural trilingual sociolinguistic environment in which English functions as the third language of instruction. The experiment was organised as a three-stage process encompassing a diagnostic phase, a formative phase of 16 lessons across eight weeks, and a summative control phase, each

assigned a distinct set of research tasks and systematically aligned with the TOWE curriculum.

The methodological choices described in this chapter provide a rigorous and replicable foundation for the experimental and empirical work presented in Chapter III.

CHAPTER III. EXPERIMENTAL AND EMPIRICAL WORK ON IMPLEMENTING A LEVEL-BASED MODEL OF DIFFERENTIATED ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING IN GRADE 6

3.1. Content and Implementation of the Level-Based Model of Differentiated Instruction

This section delineates the structural composition and practical execution of the level-based model of differentiated instruction, developed and validated during the formative stage of the experiment. Specifically, it addresses the criteria and results of student stratification based on diagnostic testing, the pedagogical characteristics of each proficiency-based group, the principles of differentiated task design and lesson organization, and the dynamics of the model's implementation throughout the eight-week intervention.

3.1.1. Level-Based Stratification and Pre-Test Results

The distribution of students into differentiated groups was conducted on January 14, 2026, following the three-session diagnostic assessment. The primary basis for level assignment was the final cumulative score on a 100-point scale. In accordance with the descriptors developed for this study, three score ranges were established, corresponding to three distinct levels of language proficiency. The use of score thresholds as the grouping criterion was dictated by the need to ensure objectivity and transparency in the stratification process: grouping was based on measurable data regarding students' actual proficiency across all four assessed language skills, rather than on subjective pedagogical observation. The distribution of students across the three proficiency levels is presented in Table 2.2.

Table 2.2

**Distribution of Students by Proficiency Level (Based on Pre-Test
Results)**

Level	Group Name	Score Range	No. of Students	% of Class
Level 1	Correction and Support	0–45	14	58.3%

Level	Group Name	Score Range	No. of Students	% of Class
Level 2	Standard and Guidance	46–75	8	33.3%
Level 3	Autonomous Development	76–100	2	8.3%
	Total		24	100%

As indicated in Table 2.2, more than half of the students – 14 out of 24 – demonstrated proficiency requiring targeted corrective intervention and were assigned to Level 1. Eight students performed within the standard range and were placed in Level 2. Only two students (8.3%) demonstrated a sufficiently high level of independent proficiency to be categorized under Level 3. The pronounced concentration of students at the lowest proficiency tier underscores the pedagogical necessity of a differentiated instructional model: a traditional, uniform approach would fail to simultaneously address the remedial needs of Level 1 students while providing adequate academic challenge for those at Levels 2 and 3. The complete individual pre-test results for all 24 participants are provided in Appendix 5.

3.1.2. Pedagogical Characteristics of the Proficiency Groups

Based on the diagnostic findings, each proficiency group was assigned a distinct instructional profile reflecting the specific linguistic needs and learning capacities identified through the pre-test data. The development of the level-based model prioritized the adaptation of the curriculum to the unique capabilities of each learner, ensuring that overarching learning goals remained consistent while the methods of attainment were diversified.

Level 1: Correction and Support (n=14)

This level was designated for learners who had acquired basic literacy skills during the previous academic year but continued to encounter significant difficulties in independent sentence construction and phrase production. The instructional focus was centered on Controlled Activities providing a highly structured environment for language use, supported by continuous scaffolding including grammatical reference tables, standardized work samples, visual templates, and substitution frames.

The diagnostic results confirmed this profile. The majority of Group 1 students were unable to construct independent utterances during the speaking

assessment, producing only isolated words or memorized phrases. Written work consisted of disconnected words with severe orthographic errors. Several students scored 0–1 points out of 5 in the reading component. Grammar scores revealed systemic errors in the use of the verb to be and personal pronouns, indicating that foundational syntactic structures had not yet been internalized.

Level 2: Standard and Guidance (n=8)

The second level comprised students who demonstrated established reading proficiency and the ability to communicate on fundamental, everyday topics. The pedagogical emphasis shifted toward Guided Practice – a deliberate transition from teacher dependence toward greater learner autonomy – with materials containing fewer explicit prompts than those at Level 1, and an organizational structure designed to help students refine communicative accuracy and fluency.

The pre-test data corroborated this characterization. Group 2 students demonstrated the ability to construct simple sentences and sustain basic communicative exchanges; however, written output lacked structural coherence, consisting of four to six unconnected sentences with frequent grammatical errors. Vocabulary and reading scores were comparatively strong, indicating that receptive language knowledge exceeded productive language use a discrepancy that informed the design of guided tasks oriented toward more independent and accurate language production.

Level 3: Autonomous Development (n=2)

The final level was designated for students who had successfully mastered the foundational linguistic competencies of the curriculum and were capable of engaging with standard educational materials without simplified adaptations. The model emphasized Independent Learning, incorporating creative and cognitively demanding assignments that challenged these students to transcend standard textbook content, fostering sophisticated spontaneous speech and a high degree of learner agency.

The diagnostic data confirmed that both students demonstrated near-complete command of the assessed skills: speaking scores reached 40–46 out of 50, with fluent

and extended responses, while written work was structurally coherent with appropriate use of connectors and accurate orthography. The primary pedagogical goal for this group was continued development and enrichment rather than correction or remediation.

Having established the instructional profiles of each proficiency group, the next stage involved the design of differentiated task sets addressing the specific needs of each level within a unified lesson framework.

3.1.3. Principles of Level-Based Task Development and Instructional Implementation

The instructional profiles outlined above served as the direct basis for the development of the differentiated task system, which constituted the core operational element of the level-based model. A fundamental principle underlying the entire instructional design was the concept of a unified thematic framework with diversified pathways of attainment: across all 16 lessons of the formative stage, every session was built around a single thematic unit drawn from the TOWE curriculum, ensuring that all students received the same conceptual input while the complexity and degree of support embedded in their respective tasks varied systematically according to their assigned proficiency level.

AI-Assisted Material Development

A distinctive feature of the material development process was the integration of AI-based language generation tools as an instructional preparation aid. Given the requirement to prepare three differentiated task variants for every productive stage of every lesson across the eight-week period, the following procedure was consistently applied: the original textbook exercise, the thematic objective of the lesson, and the pedagogical profiles of the three proficiency groups were provided as input, and three calibrated task variants aligned with each group's specific linguistic capacity were generated accordingly. For example, for the lesson on "The Weather's Very Nice" (Unit 4, January 19, 2026), this process yielded: a substitution table with sentence frames for Group 1 ("It is + [weather]. I am + [feeling]."); a dialogue skeleton for Group 2 ("– Look! It is... – Yes, it is. – I am... – Me too!"); and

an open-ended weather forecast task for Group 3, requiring independent oral production without structural support. This approach enabled the precise calibration of scaffolding elements to the specific linguistic needs of each group while maintaining full alignment with the thematic content of each lesson. The procedure was replicated systematically across all 16 lessons of the formative stage. A representative example of AI-assisted task adaptation is provided in Appendix 6.

Lesson Structure

Each of the 16 lessons was conducted during a standard 45-minute instructional period, adhering to a consistent five-stage organizational framework designed to integrate differentiation selectively and strategically. Stage I (Warm-up, 5 min) was implemented frontally for the entire cohort without differentiation, with the objective of activating prior vocabulary, establishing a positive psychological climate, and preparing students for productive language use. Activities as vocabulary drills, teacher-led exchanges, mnemonic games were identical for all three proficiency levels, ensuring a uniform point of entry.

Stage II (Presentation, 10 min) similarly omitted differentiation in favor of universal access to linguistic input. New lexical units were introduced using TOWE audio resources, supplemented by visual demonstrations and choral repetition. Grammatical structures were presented through illustrative models on the chalkboard, and key terminology was translated into the students' native language where necessary to facilitate comprehension within the trilingual learning context.

Stage III (Controlled Practice, 10 min) applied differentiation partially through the strategic use of scaffolding and varied task complexity. Level 1 learners received enhanced support through bilingual word lists and constant individual guidance. Level 2 students completed exercises independently. Level 3 students were assigned extended analytical tasks — such as error correction or written justifications — requiring a higher degree of cognitive engagement.

Stage IV (Productive Stage, 15 min) represented the period of full, systematic differentiation. Students worked with individual printed handouts tailored to their proficiency level, distributed discreetly. Level 1 students engaged in controlled

activities such as substitution table tasks or sentence frame completion. Level 2 participants focused on guided practice constructing dialogues or short paragraphs based on structural outlines. Level 3 learners performed independent tasks including oral reports and creative descriptions without external scaffolding.

Stage V (Conclusion and Reflection, 5 min) facilitated the presentation of student work and served as a mechanism for formative assessment. Level 3 students presented oral reports or complex written responses; Level 2 and Level 1 students shared dialogues and scaffolded sentences respectively. This structure allowed the monitoring of progress across all levels while providing a natural opportunity for peer modeling. Following the completion of each thematic unit, students utilized differentiated self-assessment sheets to reflect on their mastery of the material and the effectiveness of the provided support tools.

3.1.4. Sample Lesson: Application of the Three-Level Task Matrix

The lesson conducted on January 19, 2026, on the topic "The Weather's Very Nice" (Unit 4, TOWE, pp. 30–31) is presented as a representative illustration of the differentiated instructional model in practice. The learning objective was to enable students to describe weather conditions and personal physical states using Present Simple structures. This lesson was selected because it demonstrates all five structural stages, incorporates all three types of differentiated tasks, and reflects the organizational principles applied consistently across the formative stage.

Stage I — Warm-up (5 min). The lesson opened with the game "What's in the bag?". Flashcards depicting weather conditions and realia items (an umbrella, sunglasses, a scarf) were displayed. Students responded chorally to the question "What's this? Is it for hot or cold weather?" No differentiation was applied; all three groups participated equally.

Stage II — Presentation (10 min). New weather vocabulary was introduced using Audio 4.1 (cloudy, cold, hot, ice, rain, snow, sunny, weather, wet, wind, windy). Students followed along in their textbooks and repeated chorally. Audio 4.2 (Exercise 1) was used for dialogue comprehension. All three groups received identical input.

Stage III — Controlled Practice (10 min). Exercise 2 "Listen and write numbers" was completed by the whole class simultaneously. Students numbered pictures A through H based on audio. During the checking phase, the teacher named a letter and students responded with the number and word (e.g., "A is 3. It's hot."). Additional individual guidance was provided to Group 1 students.

Stage IV — Productive Stage: Differentiated Task Matrix (15 min). Individual differentiated handouts were distributed discreetly. The tasks assigned to each proficiency level are presented in Table 2.3.

Table 2.3

Three-Level Task Matrix – Unit 4 "The Weather's Very Nice" (January 19, 2026)

Group	Activity Type	Target Task	Scaffolding Tool
Group 1 (n=14)	Controlled Activity	Writing: construct 4 simple sentences based on visual prompts (p. 30)	Substitution table: It is + [weather]. I am + [feeling].
Group 2 (n=8)	Guided Practice	Speaking: compose and role-play a short dialogue based on textbook illustrations (Ex. 1)	Dialogue skeleton: — Look! It is... — Yes, it is. — I am... — Me too!
Group 3 (n=2)	Independent Learning	Reporting: prepare and deliver an oral weather forecast based on the full illustration	Report outline: 1. Hello, I am... 2. Today the weather is... 3. In the mountains... 4. Have a nice day!

Stage V – Conclusion and Reflection (5 min). Group 3 presented their weather forecasts to the class. Group 2 performed one dialogue. Group 1 submitted their written sentences for teacher review. Qualitative feedback was collected by posing the questions: "Who found the substitution table helpful today?" and "Who learned to say how they feel about the weather?" Responses were recorded in the IMPs. Upon completion of this thematic unit, students completed Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets administered in Kyrgyz to ensure full accessibility in the trilingual learning context (see Appendix 3). The complete lesson plan is provided in Appendix 7.

This sample lesson illustrates the fundamental operational principle of the level-based model: a single thematic framework, a single set of learning objectives, and a single timeline yet three distinct pathways of engagement, each calibrated to the specific linguistic capacity of its assigned group. This principle was maintained consistently across all 16 lessons of the formative stage.

3.1.5. Dynamics of Model Implementation

The implementation of the level-based differentiated model across the eight-week formative stage constituted a dynamic pedagogical progression characterized by gradual learner adaptation, evolving instructional adjustments, and measurable qualitative growth across all three proficiency groups. The systematic documentation of this progression was made possible through the concurrent use of three complementary instruments: the Instructional Monitoring Protocols, the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets, and direct pedagogical observation (see Appendix 2; Appendix 3).

Initial Phase (Weeks 1–2): Acclimatization and Scaffolding Challenges

The opening weeks of the formative stage revealed that the primary challenge facing Group 1 was not exclusively linguistic in nature but also procedural: the majority of students had no prior experience working with structured instructional scaffolds. Approximately four students within Group 1 demonstrated a persistent misapplication of the scaffolding tools during the first two to three lessons, completing tasks without consulting the substitution tables and consequently producing incorrect or incomplete responses. This pattern was systematically documented in the IMPs.

In response to these observations, targeted individual instruction was provided during the productive stage to model the correct application of the substitution table and clarify its function as a structural support rather than an optional aid. This intervention proved effective: by the conclusion of the second week, all Group 1 students had developed a functional understanding of how to apply the provided scaffolding structures. Within Group 2, two students demonstrated consistent task performance that noticeably exceeded the demands of the guided practice activities,

completing all exercises accurately observations recorded in the IMPs as early indicators of potential upward level transition.

Active Phase (Weeks 3–5): Growing Confidence and Positive Self-Assessment Data

As the formative stage progressed into its middle phase, the qualitative data accumulated through the Self-Assessment Sheets reflected a discernible shift in student confidence. The majority of Group 1 students reported affirmative responses to prompts concerning their ability to construct sentences using the provided scaffolding structures and to recall and apply newly introduced vocabulary items. These self-reported indicators corroborated direct classroom observations showing that Group 1 students were increasingly initiating task engagement independently rather than waiting passively for individual teacher intervention (see Appendix 3).

Several Group 2 students indicated in their reflection sheets that they had begun supplementing the provided dialogue skeletons with independently generated lexical and syntactic additions a qualitative indicator of emerging linguistic autonomy exceeding the structural boundaries of the guided practice task format. The IMPs maintained during this phase concurrently documented a reduction in the frequency of individual teacher interventions required by Group 1 students during the productive stage, further substantiating the self-assessment data as a reliable indicator of genuine procedural and linguistic progress (see Appendix 2).

Developmental Phase (Weeks 6–7): Level Transitions and Extended Challenges

The most pedagogically significant developments of the formative stage occurred during this phase, when the gradual increase in task complexity yielded observable instances of upward level transition defined within this study as the successful completion by a student of tasks designed for a proficiency level higher than that originally assigned.

One student from Group 1 demonstrated a consistently elevated quality of task completion, producing written output that structurally and lexically exceeded the requirements of the controlled activity format. Supplementary tasks drawn from the

Group 2 task set were provided as additional challenge material, which the student completed with a satisfactory degree of accuracy. This instance was recorded in the dynamic progress section of the IMPs (see Appendix 2). Among Group 2, three students demonstrated the capacity to engage productively with tasks designed for Group 3 including extended oral descriptions, analytically structured written responses, and open-ended reporting activities albeit with residual grammatical inaccuracies. A flexible supplementary approach was adopted, providing Group 3 tasks as optional extensions while retaining the structural security of the assigned group's scaffolding framework.

One case warrants specific consideration: a newly enrolled student who had joined the school at the commencement of the academic year with no measurable prior English language background. While this student consistently required additional time to complete assigned tasks, the quality of completed work was accurate and structurally sound. By the developmental phase, the student had begun actively participating in whole-class frontal questioning raising a hand to respond to teacher-directed questions a behavioral shift indicative of qualitative growth in learner confidence and willingness to engage publicly with the target language.

Concluding Phase (Week 8): Consolidation and Observable Outcomes

By the final week of the formative stage, task completion rates across the class had reached near 100% a significant improvement compared to pre-experimental instructional conditions, during which students frequently submitted incomplete work or disengaged when confronted with undifferentiated tasks that did not correspond to their individual proficiency level. Every student who completed a task received individualized formative feedback identifying specific areas for improvement, thereby establishing a continuous pedagogical cycle of task completion, evaluative response, and corrective guidance.

A documented instance of spontaneous learner initiative provided qualitative evidence of motivational development attributable to level-appropriate task design: one student from Group 1, without teacher prompting, independently approached the classroom board and produced a sentence derived from the lesson content. This

behavioral shift in a student who had required consistent individual scaffolding support at the outset of the experiment was recorded in the IMPs as an indicator of increased learner agency and self-efficacy (see Appendix 2).

Formal academic performance data provided further corroboration of these qualitative observations: four students from Group 1 received a grade of "Good" (4) for the third academic quarter of the 2025–2026 school year, in contrast to grades of "Satisfactory" (3) recorded for the same students in both the first and second quarters (see Appendix 2; Appendix 3).

Collectively, the dynamics documented across the four phases of the formative stage demonstrate that the level-based differentiated model functioned not merely as a task distribution mechanism but as a comprehensive pedagogical system capable of simultaneously addressing remedial learning needs, sustaining grade-level academic challenge, and fostering the motivational conditions necessary for productive engagement with the target language. The quantitative verification of these outcomes through the comparative analysis of assessment data is presented in the following section.

3.2. Analysis of the Results of the Experimental and Empirical Work

The present section provides a comprehensive analysis of the quantitative and qualitative outcomes of the pedagogical experiment, addressing three interconnected dimensions: the overall comparative dynamics between the pre-test and post-test assessments, the group-level patterns of progress, and the skill-specific trajectories observed across the four domains of communicative competence. The quantitative findings are further contextualized through reference to the qualitative data accumulated during the formative stage.

3.2.1. Comparative Overview of Pre-Test and Post-Test Results

The primary quantitative data of the experiment were obtained through the administration of a standardized 100-point diagnostic assessment at the outset of the formative stage (January 12–14, 2026) and an equivalent summative assessment

upon its conclusion (March 23–24, 2026). Both instruments evaluated student performance across four domains: Speaking, Listening, Writing, and Use of English using identical scoring parameters to ensure the comparability of results. The individual pre-test and post-test scores for all 24 participants are presented in Table 2.4. For further information see Appendix 8.

Table 2.4

Individual Pre-Test and Post-Test Results (n=24)

Student Code	Pre-Test (pts)	Post-Test (pts)	Growth (pts)	Level Transition
S1	19.0	37.1	+18.1	Level 1 → Level 1
S2	27.0	39.3	+12.3	Level 1 → Level 1
S3	22.0	26.3	+4.3	Level 1 → Level 1
S4	46.0	55.6	+9.6	Level 2 → Level 2
S5	37.5	59.1	+21.6	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
S6	68.0	74.8	+6.8	Level 2 → Level 2
S7	15.0	22.8	+7.8	Level 1 → Level 1
S8	53.5	63.0	+9.5	Level 2 → Level 2
S9	65.0	84.0	+19.0	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
S10	44.0	53.3	+9.3	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
S11	35.0	50.4	+15.4	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
S12	11.0	29.8	+18.8	Level 1 → Level 1
S13	50.5	61.3	+10.8	Level 2 → Level 2
S14	21.0	25.0	+4.0	Level 1 → Level 1
S15	87.0	91.0	+4.0	Level 3 → Level 3
S16	19.0	42.1	+23.1	Level 1 → Level 1
S17	78.0	86.5	+8.5	Level 3 → Level 3
S18	18.0	32.5	+14.5	Level 1 → Level 1
S19	60.0	78.5	+18.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
S20	4.0	18.8	+14.8	Level 1 → Level 1
S21	63.0	76.5	+13.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
S22	11.0	18.5	+7.5	Level 1 → Level 1
S23	63.0	77.5	+14.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
S24	13.5	37.0	+23.5	Level 1 → Level 1

Student Code	Pre-Test (pts)	Post-Test (pts)	Growth (pts)	Level Transition
Mean	37.6	51.9	+14.3	

The data presented in Table 2.4 reveal a universal pattern of positive growth: every participant in the study demonstrated an improvement in total score between the pre-test and post-test assessments, with individual gains ranging from 4.0 points (S14 and S15) to 23.5 points (S24). The mean score for the entire cohort increased from 37.6 points at the diagnostic stage to 51.9 points at the summative stage, representing an average gain of 14.3 points equivalent to a 38% improvement relative to the pre-test mean. These results provide initial quantitative evidence of the positive impact of the level-based differentiated model on student performance across all proficiency levels.

Of particular significance is the pattern of growth observed among students with the lowest baseline scores. S24 demonstrated a gain of 23.5 points (13.5 → 37.0), S16 improved by 23.1 points (19.0 → 42.1), and S5 recorded a gain of 21.6 points (37.5 → 59.1), the latter representing a documented upward level transition from Level 1 to Level 2. This pattern suggests that the level-based differentiated model was particularly effective for students with the most pronounced initial deficits, providing them with structured pathways for productive engagement through scaffolded tasks calibrated to their proximal zone of development.

3.2.2. Group-Level Analysis

A more granular examination of the data at the group level reveals a differentiated pattern of progress reflecting the specific pedagogical interventions applied to each proficiency tier. The group-level comparative data are presented in Table 2.5.

Table 2.5.

Group-Level Pre-Test and Post-Test Comparison

Group	n	Pre-Test Mean	Post-Test Mean	Mean Growth	Upward Transitions
Level 1 (0–45)	14	21.9	35.1	+13.2	3 students → Level 2

Group	n	Pre-Test Mean	Post-Test Mean	Mean Growth	Upward Transitions
Level 2 (46–75)	8	58.6	68.4	+9.8	4 students → Level 3
Level 3 (76–100)	2	82.5	88.75	+6.25	— (remained at Level 3)
Whole Class	24	37.6	51.9	+14.3	7 total transitions

Group 1 – "Correction and Support"

Group 1 demonstrated the highest absolute mean growth of the three groups, with an average gain of 13.2 points (21.9 → 35.1). Three students achieved post-test scores exceeding 45 points and were formally reclassified to Level 2. The most notable individual gains were recorded by S24 (+23.5 points) and S16 (+23.1 points) both of whom had experienced difficulties with scaffolding tools during the initial phase but demonstrated consistent improvement throughout the formative period.

It should be acknowledged that a subset of Group 1 students with the most critically low baseline scores did not achieve the threshold for Level 2 reclassification. The data suggest that an eight-week intervention period was insufficient to fully remediate systemic language deficits accumulated over several years of instruction. Nevertheless, the consistent positive trajectory observed across all Group 1 participants confirms that the differentiated model initiated a meaningful process of corrective development.

Group 2 – "Standard and Guidance"

Group 2 recorded a mean growth of 9.8 points (58.6 → 68.4). The most consequential outcome was the upward level transition of four of its eight members – a 50% transition rate – each achieving a post-test score exceeding 75 points and thereby reclassified to Level 3. This finding constitutes a compelling quantitative indicator of the model's effectiveness: the systematic application of guided practice tasks with gradually reducing scaffolding created sufficient conditions for half of this group to achieve autonomous-level proficiency within the experimental timeframe. The most significant individual gains were recorded by S9 (+19.0 points,

65.0 → 84.0) and S19 (+18.5 points, 60.0 → 78.5), both identified during the developmental phase as candidates for extended Level 3 task exposure.

Group 3 – "Autonomous Development"

Group 3 demonstrated the smallest absolute mean growth of 6.25 points (82.5 → 88.75). This outcome is consistent with the well-established pedagogical principle that students at the highest proficiency tier possess a considerably smaller margin for measurable improvement within a standardized 100-point framework. Both students maintained their Level 3 classification, with S15 reaching 91.0 points and S17 achieving 86.5 points on the post-test.

The distribution shift across proficiency levels between the pre-test and post-test is presented in Figure 3.1.

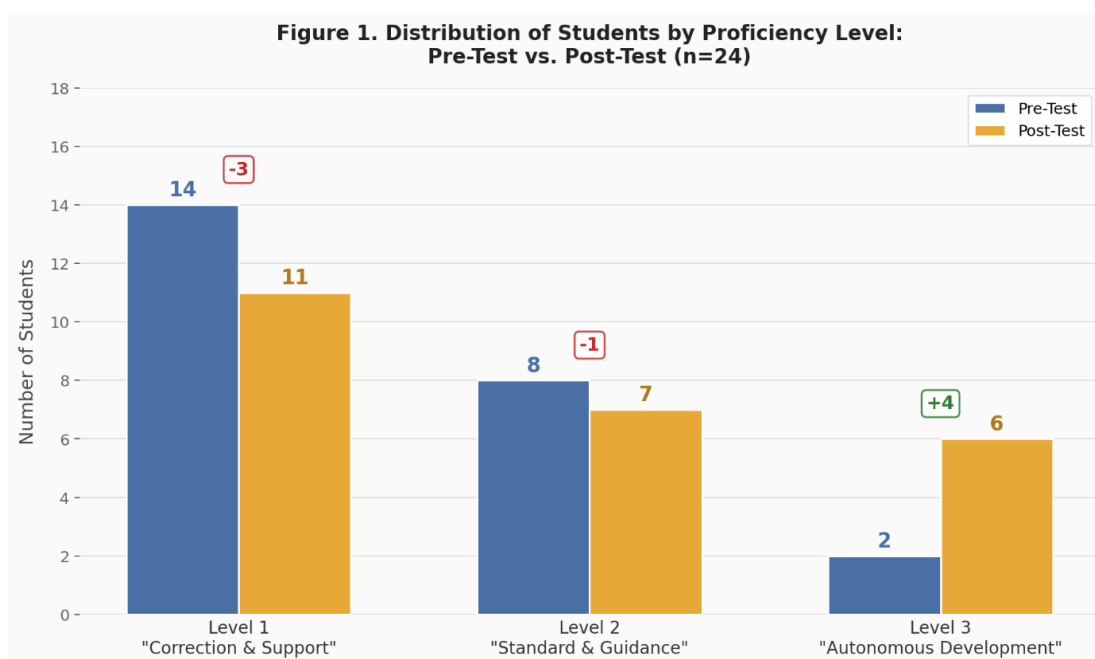


Figure 3.1 – Distribution of Students by Proficiency Level: Pre-Test vs. Post-Test (n=24)

The data presented in Figure 3.1 reveal a statistically meaningful redistribution of students across proficiency levels. The proportion of students classified at Level 3 tripled from 8.3% (n=2) to 25.0% (n=6) while the proportion at Level 1 decreased from 58.3% to 45.8%. The number of Level 2 students decreased from 8 to 7, as four students transitioned upward to Level 3 while three moved from Level 1 to Level 2. In total, seven instances of upward level transition were recorded: three from Level 1 to Level 2, and four from Level 2 to Level 3. This

distributional shift indicates that the level-based differentiated model was effective not only in producing score improvements but in facilitating genuine qualitative advancement in student proficiency classification.

3.2.3. Skill-Level Analysis

To obtain a more precise understanding of the pedagogical impact of the differentiated model, the comparative data were disaggregated by individual skill domain. The relative growth rates across skill domains are visualized in Figure 3.2.

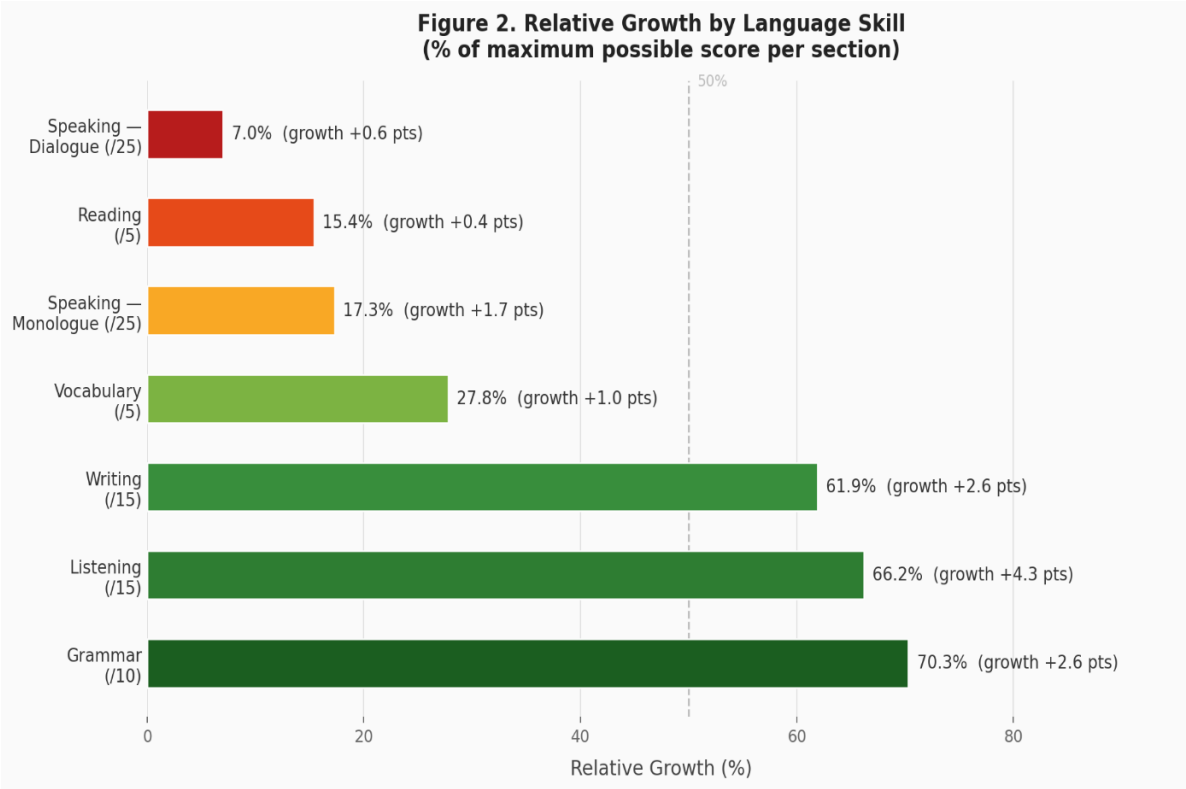


Figure 3.2 – Relative Growth by Language Skill (% of maximum possible score per section)

The skill-level data visualized in Figure 3.2 reveal a differentiated pattern of growth across the assessed domains. The most substantial relative improvements were recorded in Grammar (+70.3%), Listening (+66.2%), and Writing (+61.9%), reflecting the direct impact of the scaffolded instructional approach on students' productive and receptive skill development.

The strongest absolute gain was recorded in Listening, with the class mean rising from 6.5 to 10.8 out of 15 an improvement of 4.3 points. This outcome reflects the cumulative effect of systematic audio exposure through the TOWE curriculum

across 16 lessons, complemented by the progressive development of auditory processing skills facilitated by the differentiated instructional approach.

Writing demonstrated an equally significant relative gain (+61.9%), with the class mean rising from 4.2 to 6.8 points. This improvement holds particular pedagogical significance given that Writing was identified at the diagnostic stage as the most critically underdeveloped skill across the cohort. The systematic deployment of substitution tables, sentence frames, and structural scaffolds during the productive stage appears to have contributed directly to students' capacity for organized written production, with improvements evident across all three proficiency groups.

Grammar recorded the highest relative growth of all assessed components (+70.3%), rising from a class mean of 3.7 to 6.3 out of 10. This finding corroborates the effectiveness of structured grammatical scaffolding — primarily substitution tables and sentence frames — as instruments for the initial acquisition and progressive automatization of foundational syntactic structures. The most pronounced gains were observed among Group 1 students, whose baseline grammar scores had been critically low.

The comparatively modest growth in Speaking particularly in the Dialogue component (+7.0%) , warrants methodological explanation. The post-test Speaking assessment evaluated students on the topic of personal appearance and identity, which was thematically and lexically more demanding than the pre-test Speaking tasks. The heightened complexity of the summative Speaking prompt placed considerably greater demands on spontaneous language production than the pre-test equivalent. In several cases, students who had demonstrated consistent communicative progress throughout the formative stage received marginally lower Speaking scores on the post-test. This pattern is attributable to the increased thematic complexity of the summative task rather than to any regression in communicative competence — a conclusion corroborated by the qualitative evidence from the IMPs, which consistently recorded improvements in student oral task performance across the formative period (see Appendix 2).

Vocabulary demonstrated a moderate but consistent gain (+27.8%), with the class mean rising from 3.6 to 4.6 out of 5. As this component was relatively strong even at the diagnostic stage, the smaller growth differential is explicable in terms of a ceiling effect rather than instructional insufficiency. Reading recorded the smallest relative gain (+15.4%), rising from 2.6 to 3.0 points. The development of reading as a complex receptive skill requires sustained exposure over a considerably longer timeframe than eight weeks of differentiated instruction; the modest but positive growth is accordingly interpretable as a meaningful initial increment.

3.2.4. Qualitative Indicators of Progress

The quantitative results presented in Sections 3.1.1–3.1.3 are substantiated and contextualized by the qualitative evidence accumulated through the Instructional Monitoring Protocols and the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets administered throughout the formative stage.

The Self-Assessment Sheets required students to evaluate their own performance by marking affirmative or negative responses against targeted reflective statements corresponding to the specific tasks completed by their proficiency group. The language and complexity of the statements were calibrated to each group level. For Group 1, statements were framed in simple, task-specific language: "I named 5 new weather words using the substitution table"; "I wrote 4 sentences in my notebook using the board "; "I managed to write sentences without looking at the table too many times." For Group 2, statements reflected guided productive competencies: "I composed a dialogue with my partner and performed it for the class"; "I correctly used the dialogue skeleton from the board"; "I added my own words to the dialogue that were not in the skeleton." For Group 3, statements addressed autonomous linguistic performance: "I prepared and delivered an oral weather forecast for the class"; "I described weather conditions in different locations"; "I spoke freely without reading from paper and added complex words."

The self-assessment data revealed a consistent pattern of growing learner confidence across all three groups. Among Group 1 students, the proportion of affirmative responses increased progressively from the initial to the concluding

thematic units. Of particular significance were the affirmative responses to "I managed to write sentences without looking at the table too many times" , a prompt designed to capture emerging independence from the substitution scaffold. The increasing frequency of such responses across successive self-assessment cycles provided direct qualitative evidence of the gradual internalization of grammatical structures (see Appendix 3).

Among Group 2, several students marked affirmative responses to "I added my own words to the dialogue that were not in the skeleton" , an indicator of productive linguistic autonomy that exceeded the structural boundaries of the guided practice task format. This self-reported evidence of creative language use beyond the provided scaffold corroborated the corresponding IMP entries and anticipated the upward level transitions subsequently documented in the post-test data. Group 3 self-assessment data consistently reflected high levels of task completion and learner confidence, with affirmative responses to statements such as "I spoke freely without reading from paper" and "I helped my classmates understand the difficult words in English", confirming that the autonomous-level task design sustained academic challenge at the highest proficiency tier (see Appendix 3).

The IMPs provided a complementary longitudinal record of qualitative progress. Entries across the formative period documented a progressive reduction in the frequency of teacher interventions required by Group 1 students during the productive stage — particularly notable between the initial and active phases. By the developmental phase, the majority of Group 1 students were independently initiating task engagement by consulting their scaffolding materials without awaiting individual teacher prompting. This behavioral shift suggests that the differentiated model generated genuine gains in learner autonomy rather than merely improving task performance under direct supervision (see Appendix 2).

The near-universal task completion rate documented by the concluding phase of the formative stage (see Section 2.2.5) further corroborates these findings. The consistent engagement of all students with their level-appropriate tasks, in contrast to pre-experimental instructional conditions, represents a qualitative outcome of

considerable pedagogical significance that the quantitative test data alone cannot fully capture.

3.2.5. Assessment of the Model's Effectiveness and Study Limitations

The convergent analysis of quantitative and qualitative data supports the conclusion that the level-based differentiated instructional model demonstrated measurable effectiveness as a pedagogical intervention for Grade 6 students in a multilingual rural school context.

The universal positive growth recorded across all 24 participants, the cohort mean improvement of 14.3 points (38% relative to the pre-test mean), the tripling of the Level 3 cohort from 2 to 6 students, seven documented upward level transitions, the near-universal task completion rate during the concluding formative phase, and the qualitative evidence of growing learner autonomy collectively constitute a robust body of evidence in support of the model's capacity to simultaneously correct foundational language deficits, sustain grade-level academic challenge, and facilitate genuine advancement in communicative competence across all three proficiency tiers.

The observed pattern of differential skill growth , with Grammar, Listening, and Writing demonstrating the strongest relative improvements — is consistent with the theoretical framework of the study. The qualitative evidence demonstrates that improvements in test scores were accompanied by genuine shifts in learner behaviour, self-perception, and motivational engagement, providing interpretive depth to the quantitative findings.

Nevertheless, several limitations of the present study should be acknowledged. First, the absence of a control group prevents the unambiguous attribution of observed gains to the model; other instructional factors cannot be fully excluded. Second, the researcher's concurrent role as the students' teacher represents a source of potential observer bias that may have influenced qualitative data collection. Third, the non-equivalence of pre-test and post-test Speaking task demands , as noted in Section 3.1.3 , limits the direct comparability of Speaking scores and constitutes a design limitation that should be addressed in subsequent research. Fourth, the study

sample (n=24) restricts the generalisability of the findings beyond the specific school context in which the experiment was conducted. These limitations notwithstanding, the consistency of positive outcomes across quantitative and qualitative instruments, and across all three proficiency tiers, supports the conclusion that the systematic implementation of the level-based differentiated instructional model, grounded in diagnostic data and supported by targeted scaffolding, produces statistically and pedagogically significant improvements in the English language proficiency of Grade 6 students in heterogeneous classroom conditions.

Conclusions for Chapter III

The experimental and empirical work presented in Chapter III confirms the feasibility and pedagogical productivity of implementing a level-based differentiated model of English language instruction in a rural multilingual classroom setting. The diagnostic stratification of 24 Grade 6 students into three proficiency-based groups Level 1 (Correction and Support, n=14), Level 2 (Standard and Guidance, n=8), and Level 3 (Autonomous Development, n=2) provided an empirically grounded foundation for the design of differentiated task sets, the calibration of instructional scaffolding, and the organization of lesson delivery across all 16 sessions of the formative stage.

The quantitative analysis of pre-test and post-test results revealed a universal pattern of positive growth across all 24 participants, with a mean class improvement of 14.3 points (37.6 → 51.9, representing a 38% gain). Seven documented instances of upward level transition were recorded, including the reclassification of three Level 1 students to Level 2 and four Level 2 students to Level 3. The most substantial relative improvements were recorded in Grammar (+70.3%), Listening (+66.2%), and Writing (+61.9%), reflecting the direct contribution of structured scaffolding to the development of both productive and receptive language skills.

The qualitative evidence accumulated through the Instructional Monitoring Protocols and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets corroborated the quantitative findings, revealing a consistent pattern of growing learner confidence, increasing task completion rates, and emerging learner autonomy. These outcomes collectively

affirm that the level-based differentiated model functioned not as a mechanism of academic segregation but as an inclusive instructional system that simultaneously addressed remedial needs, maintained grade-level challenge, and fostered conditions for productive engagement with the target language across all proficiency tiers.

CONCLUSION

The present dissertation was directed toward the development, theoretical substantiation, and experimental verification of a level-based model of differentiated English language instruction for Grade 6 classrooms as a means of correcting and developing the basic speech skills of learners with heterogeneous linguistic profiles in a rural multilingual school of the Kyrgyz Republic. The findings of the research permit the formulation of the following generalising conclusions, structured in accordance with the objectives established in the introduction.

1. Theoretical Foundations of Level-Based Differentiation

A systematic review of the scholarly literature established that level-based differentiation as a pedagogical technology finds its theoretical justification in a set of mutually reinforcing conceptual frameworks: the student-centred approach, the systemic-activity approach, the concept of the Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD) advanced by L.S. Vygotsky, and the descriptor system of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR). These frameworks collectively constitute a three-tier hierarchical foundation: an axiological level, which affirms the uniqueness of each individual learner and their right to an individual developmental trajectory; a technological level, which governs the design of activity-oriented instructional tasks and the systemic organisation of differentiated learning processes; and a prognostic level, which defines the measurable trajectory of each student's advancement through the ZPD toward the prescribed CEFR proficiency threshold. The analysis demonstrated that, without this principled theoretical basis, differentiation risks degenerating into a mechanical distribution of tasks devoid of genuine pedagogical strategy.

The student-centred approach establishes the axiological foundation of the model, answering the question of who constitutes the subject of learning. The systemic-activity approach provides the technological instrument, defining how learning is carried out through the design of progressively demanding communicative tasks. The ZPD and the CEFR descriptors together supply the prognostic vector, specifying the direction in which learning is oriented and

providing the objective criteria against which progress is measured. The integration of these three levels of methodological grounding ensures that the model functions not as a collection of isolated instructional techniques but as a coherent, theoretically driven pedagogical strategy.

2. Structural Design and Organisational Logic of the Level-Based Model

The level-based model developed in the present study is operationalised through five interrelated pedagogical principles : individualisation, dynamism, unity of goals, accessibility, and progressive complexity, which collectively ensure the internal logical coherence of the model and distinguish it from traditional undifferentiated approaches to instruction. The organisational instrument of the model is a five-stage differentiated lesson structure: comprising a warm-up, a presentation phase, controlled practice, a productive stage, and a reflection and conclusion phase — within which systematic differentiation is concentrated at the productive stage through the deployment of a three-tier task matrix: controlled tasks with structured scaffolding (Level 1), guided practice tasks with gradually reducing support (Level 2), and independent creative tasks (Level 3). The unity of thematic content across all three proficiency tiers, combined with the variability of the pathways through which each group engages with that content, ensures compliance with the normative requirements of the state educational standard for all learners simultaneously.

A distinctive feature of the model's design is the integration of AI-assisted language generation tools as an instrument of systematic task adaptation. Given the requirement to prepare three differentiated task variants for the productive stage of every lesson across the eight-week intervention period, the incorporation of AI tools as a preparation resource enabled the precise calibration of scaffolding elements to the specific linguistic profile of each proficiency group while maintaining full alignment with the thematic content and curricular objectives of each lesson. This represents a methodological innovation with significant implications for the scalability and replicability of the model in instructional contexts characterised by comparable resource constraints.

3. Quantitative Outcomes of the Pedagogical Experiment

The pedagogical experiment, conducted with 24 Grade 6 students between January and March 2026 under authentic classroom conditions, provided compelling quantitative evidence of the effectiveness of the level-based differentiated model. The comparative analysis of diagnostic pre-test and summative post-test results administered on a standardised 100-point scale across four domains of communicative competence (Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing) revealed a universal pattern of positive growth: every one of the 24 participants demonstrated an improvement in total score between the two assessment points.

The class mean score increased from 37.6 to 51.9 points, representing a gain of 14.3 points equivalent to a 38% improvement relative to the pre-test mean. Seven instances of upward level transition were documented: three students advanced from Level 1 to Level 2, and four students from Level 2 to Level 3. The proportion of students classified at Level 3 (Autonomous Development) tripled from 8.3% (n=2) to 25.0% (n=6) while the proportion classified at Level 1 decreased from 58.3% to 45.8%. These distributional shifts indicate that the level-based differentiated model was effective not merely in producing incremental score improvements but in facilitating genuine qualitative advancement in students' proficiency classification.

4. Skill-Level Analysis of Pedagogical Impact

The disaggregation of comparative data by individual skill domain revealed a differentiated pattern of pedagogical impact across the assessed areas of communicative competence. The most substantial relative improvements were recorded in Grammar (+70.3%), Listening (+66.2%), and Writing (+61.9%). These results are fully consistent with the theoretical framework of the study: Grammar and Writing gains reflect the direct contribution of structured scaffolding tools substitution tables, sentence frames, and grammatical reference materials to the initial acquisition and progressive automatisisation of foundational syntactic structures; Listening gains reflect the cumulative effect of systematic audio exposure through the TOWE curriculum across 16 lessons, complemented by the progressive

development of auditory processing skills facilitated by the level-appropriate task design.

The comparatively modest relative growth in Speaking particularly in the Dialogue component warrants methodological contextualisation. The post-test Speaking assessment evaluated students on a thematically and lexically more demanding topic than the pre-test equivalent, placing considerably greater demands on spontaneous language production. The convergent evidence of the Instructional Monitoring Protocols confirms that this pattern reflects the increased complexity of the summative speaking task rather than any regression in communicative competence. Vocabulary demonstrated a moderate but consistent gain (+27.8%), explicable in terms of a ceiling effect given the relative strength of this component at the diagnostic stage. Reading recorded the smallest relative improvement (+15.4%), a finding consistent with the well-established principle that the development of reading as a complex receptive skill requires sustained exposure over a timeframe considerably longer than eight weeks.

5. Qualitative Evidence of Progress

The qualitative data accumulated through the Instructional Monitoring Protocols (IMPs) and the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets corroborated and substantively enriched the quantitative findings of the experiment. The self-assessment data revealed a consistent and progressive pattern of growing learner confidence across all three proficiency groups: among Level 1 students, the frequency of affirmative responses to self-assessment prompts increased steadily across successive thematic units, with particular significance attached to responses concerning the ability to construct sentences without scaffolding support an indicator of the gradual internalisation of grammatical structures. Among Level 2 students, several instances of creative language use beyond the structural boundaries of the provided dialogue skeleton documented both in self-assessment sheets and in corresponding IMP entries provided qualitative evidence of emerging productive linguistic autonomy that anticipated the upward level transitions subsequently confirmed in the post-test data.

The IMPs documented a progressive reduction in the frequency of individual teacher interventions required by Level 1 students during the productive stage particularly marked between the initial and active phases of the formative period. By the developmental phase, the majority of Level 1 students were independently initiating task engagement by consulting their scaffolding materials without awaiting individual teacher prompting. This behavioural shift is of considerable pedagogical significance, as it suggests that the level-based model generated genuine gains in learner autonomy in the capacity to direct one's own learning activity rather than merely improving task performance under direct supervision. The near-universal task completion rate documented during the concluding phase of the formative stage, in sharp contrast to pre-experimental instructional conditions, further substantiates this interpretation.

Of particular qualitative significance was a documented instance of spontaneous learner initiative during the concluding formative phase: a Level 1 student who had required consistent individual scaffolding support at the outset of the experiment independently approached the classroom board and, without teacher prompting, produced a sentence derived from the lesson content. This behavioural shift from dependency to agency represents one of the most pedagogically meaningful outcomes of the model's implementation, as it signals the development not only of linguistic skill but of the learner's sense of themselves as a competent and active participant in the educational process.

6. Limitations of the Research and Directions for Future Investigation

A candid acknowledgement of the limitations of the present study is a prerequisite for its scientific integrity. Four principal limitations are identified. First, the absence of a control group prevents the unambiguous attribution of the observed gains to the level-based model; the influence of extraneous instructional factors cannot be wholly excluded. Second, the concurrent role of the researcher as both teacher and observer represents a potential source of observation bias that may have affected the collection and interpretation of qualitative data. Third, the non-equivalence of the pre-test and post-test Speaking task demands the summative

assessment employed a thematically more complex prompt than the diagnostic instrument limits the direct comparability of Speaking scores and constitutes a design limitation that should be addressed in subsequent research through the use of parallel test forms of controlled difficulty. Fourth, the small sample size ($n=24$) restricts the generalisability of the findings beyond the specific school context in which the experiment was conducted.

These limitations notwithstanding, the convergence of findings across three independent data sources standardised proficiency testing, Instructional Monitoring Protocols, and Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets and the universality of the positive developmental trajectory observed across all three proficiency tiers provide a robust basis for the conclusions advanced in the present study. Future research directions suggested by this work include: the replication of the experimental design with the inclusion of a control group; the extension of the intervention period to at least one full academic year; the investigation of the model's long-term impact on learner motivation and self-efficacy in English language learning; the development and validation of a more refined diagnostic instrument for the initial proficiency stratification; and the exploration of the model's transferability to other school contexts within the Kyrgyz Republic and comparable multilingual educational environments.

General Conclusion

The findings of the present dissertation confirm that a level-based model of differentiated instruction predicated on diagnostic proficiency data, operationalised through a three-tier task matrix with targeted scaffolding calibrated to each group's ZPD, and sustained by a systematic monitoring and self-assessment framework constitutes an effective pedagogical instrument for the correction and development of the basic speech skills of Grade 6 students in a multilingual rural school of the Kyrgyz Republic.

The model is not a mechanism of academic segregation. It represents, rather, an inclusive educational system that simultaneously provides corrective support for learners with the most pronounced foundational deficits, maintains an appropriate

level of academic challenge for mid-level students, and sustains the conditions for intellectually demanding, autonomous engagement with the target language for advanced learners ensuring that no student within a heterogeneous classroom is either left behind or held back by the constraints of undifferentiated, one-size-fits-all instruction.

In the sociolinguistic context of a rural school in the Kyrgyz Republic where English occupies the structurally demanding position of a third language of instruction, where learners navigate the complex cross-linguistic interference of three typologically distinct language systems, and where the gap between normative educational requirements and actual learner preparedness is most acute — level-based differentiation is not a methodological preference but a pedagogical necessity. The present research demonstrates that when this approach is systematically designed, theoretically grounded, and rigorously implemented, it is capable of transforming the heterogeneity of the classroom from an obstacle into a pedagogical resource, enabling every learner regardless of their starting point to experience meaningful progress, sustained motivation, and a genuine 'situation of success' in their development as a communicatively competent user of the English language.

The present research has been a meaningful experience of professional growth for the author. Designing and implementing the level-based model under authentic classroom conditions made it possible to move beyond a theoretical understanding of differentiated instruction toward its practical mastery as a teaching tool. One of the most significant and unexpected observations during the experiment was witnessing students transition organically between proficiency groups: learners who had been assigned to Level 1 at the diagnostic stage began, over the course of several weeks, to demonstrate performance that consistently exceeded the demands of their original group. This gradual, self-directed movement between levels was not anticipated with such clarity at the outset of the research and became one of its most personally compelling findings. At the same time, the practical organisation of differentiated instruction presented real challenges: maintaining an accurate and current record of each student's group assignment and ensuring the discreet, accurate

distribution of three distinct sets of materials within a standard 45-minute lesson required considerable organisational discipline and careful advance preparation. These challenges, however, proved instructive in themselves, as they underscored the importance of systematic planning and consistent record-keeping as non-negotiable conditions for the effective implementation of any differentiated model. Most fundamentally, the experience of conducting this research has reinforced and deepened the author's core professional conviction: that every student, regardless of their starting point, is capable of meaningful forward movement. This belief is no longer simply a pedagogical principle held in the abstract — it has been confirmed in practice, in the observable progress of 24 individual learners, and it will remain the foundation of the author's approach to teaching.

PRACTICAL RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHERS IMPLEMENTING LEVEL-BASED DIFFERENTIATED INSTRUCTION IN GRADE 6 RURAL MULTILINGUAL SCHOOLS

The following recommendations are addressed to English language teachers working in general secondary schools of the Kyrgyz Republic, particularly in rural educational settings where learner heterogeneity is most pronounced. They are grounded in the findings of the pedagogical experiment conducted at the "Amanat" Secondary School (January–March 2026) and are intended as a practical guide for the systematic implementation of a level-based model of differentiated instruction.

1. Conduct a Structured Diagnostic Assessment Before Grouping Students

Do not rely on grades from previous years or subjective impressions to determine learner levels. Administer a standardised diagnostic assessment covering all four skill domains — Speaking, Listening, Writing, and Use of English (Grammar, Vocabulary, Reading) — before the start of the intervention. Use a clear, pre-established scoring rubric and assign students to proficiency groups on the basis of objective cumulative data rather than individual skill performance alone.

A three-tier grouping structure is recommended: Level 1 (Correction and Support: 0–45 points), Level 2 (Standard and Guidance: 46–75 points), and Level 3 (Autonomous Development: 76–100 points). This corresponds to the CEFR sub-levels applicable to Grade 6 (pre-A2 to A2+) and ensures that task design is anchored in measurable proficiency descriptors rather than general impressions.

2. Keep Proficiency Groups Flexible and Dynamic

Treat the initial grouping as a starting point, not a fixed classification. Monitor student progress systematically throughout the intervention using Instructional Monitoring Protocols (IMPs) completed after each lesson. When a student demonstrates consistent performance exceeding the demands of their assigned level across two or more consecutive lessons, provide supplementary tasks from the next

level as optional extensions. Where these are completed with satisfactory accuracy, formalise the transition to the higher group.

This principle of dynamism is essential to the pedagogical effectiveness of the model: it prevents ability labelling and maintains the motivational conditions necessary for learner engagement. In the present study, seven upward level transitions were documented across the eight-week formative period.

3. Build Every Lesson Around a Five-Stage Structure

Apply a consistent five-stage lesson framework in which differentiation is concentrated strategically rather than applied uniformly throughout:

1. Warm-up (5 min) — whole-class, no differentiation. Activate prior vocabulary and establish psychological safety through games, choral drills, or teacher-led exchanges. A uniform entry point is essential for maintaining group cohesion.
2. Presentation (10 min) — whole-class, no differentiation. Introduce new lexical and grammatical material using audio resources, visual demonstrations, and choral repetition. Translate key terms into the students' native language where necessary to ensure full comprehension in the trilingual learning environment.
3. Controlled Practice (10 min) — partial differentiation. All students complete the same core exercise; Level 1 learners receive additional support (bilingual word lists, individual guidance), while Levels 2 and 3 work independently or with extended analytical tasks.
4. Productive Stage (15 min) — full differentiation. Distribute individual printed handouts discreetly (face-down, turned over simultaneously). Level 1: controlled tasks with substitution tables or sentence frames. Level 2: guided practice with dialogue skeletons or structural outlines. Level 3: independent creative tasks without external scaffolding.
5. Conclusion and Reflection (5 min) — whole-class. Level 3 students present their work as a language model for the group; Levels 2 and 1 share dialogues and scaffolded sentences respectively. Use targeted feedback questions to collect qualitative data for the IMP.

4. Design Tasks Around a Unified Theme with Variable Pathways

All three proficiency groups must work within the same thematic framework and share the same communicative learning objective. What varies is the complexity of the task, the degree of scaffolding, and the cognitive level required (aligned to Bloom's Taxonomy: Knowledge/Comprehension for Level 1; Application/Analysis for Level 2; Synthesis/Evaluation for Level 3). This principle ensures compliance with the state educational standard for all students simultaneously while creating individual developmental pathways.

For example, for a lesson on weather vocabulary (Present Simple): Level 1 writes four sentences using a substitution table on the board; Level 2 composes and performs a short dialogue using a structural skeleton; Level 3 delivers an independent oral weather forecast without external support. The topic, vocabulary set, and grammatical target are identical across all three tasks.

5. Use AI-Assisted Tools to Prepare Differentiated Task Variants Efficiently

Preparing three task variants for every lesson across a multi-week intervention is demanding. AI language generation tools (such as Google Gemini or similar platforms) can significantly reduce preparation time when used systematically. Provide the following as input: the original textbook exercise, the thematic and grammatical focus of the lesson, and the pedagogical profile of each proficiency group. Review, refine, and adapt the generated variants before classroom use — particularly to adjust scaffolding complexity and ensure cultural appropriateness for the Kyrgyz educational context.

Important: AI-generated materials serve as a preparation resource only. The teacher retains full professional responsibility for evaluating the suitability of the generated content and for any modifications introduced prior to implementation.

6. Distribute Differentiated Materials Discreetly

To minimise ability labelling and protect the psychological safety of lower-proficiency learners, distribute printed handouts face-down on students' desks before the lesson begins. Instruct all students to turn them over simultaneously on a single signal. Avoid verbal announcements of group names or levels during the lesson.

Where group names are used for organisational purposes, employ neutral descriptors (e.g., Group A, Group B, Group C) rather than evaluative labels.

7. Maintain Systematic Progress Records Using Instructional Monitoring Protocols

Complete a brief Instructional Monitoring Protocol (IMP) after each lesson. Record the following for each proficiency group: whether students engaged with the scaffolding tools independently or required individual prompting; whether any student demonstrated performance consistently exceeding their assigned level (upward transition indicator); any qualitative observations of learner confidence, motivation, or anxiety. Aggregate IMP data across the formative period to produce a cumulative picture of individual and group-level progress that goes beyond what post-test scores alone can reveal.

8. Administer Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets After Each Thematic Unit

At the end of each thematic unit (typically every two to three lessons), ask students to complete a short self-assessment sheet. For rural multilingual schools in the Kyrgyz Republic, it is strongly recommended to administer these sheets in Kyrgyz rather than English, to ensure that the affective and metacognitive data they generate are not confounded by students' limited proficiency in the target language. Self-assessment data provide qualitative evidence of growing learner confidence that precedes — and often predicts — upward level transitions measurable in post-test scores.

9. Address Foreign Language Anxiety Through the Design of the Task Environment

For Grade 6 learners in a multilingual rural school, fear of making mistakes in front of peers is a significant inhibitory factor, particularly for productive skills. The level-based model addresses this structurally: because students at the same proficiency level work on equivalent tasks simultaneously, the psychological risk associated with oral performance in a mixed-ability group is substantially reduced. Reinforce this effect by using encouraging, non-evaluative language during the

productive stage, by calling on Level 3 students first to model the target output, and by framing Level 1 scaffolding tools as "useful helpers" rather than remedial supports.

10. Plan for a Minimum Eight-Week Implementation Period

The benefits of level-based differentiated instruction are cumulative and become most visible in the middle and later phases of implementation. In the present study, the most significant qualitative developments — growing learner autonomy, reduced dependence on scaffolding, and spontaneous language use beyond task requirements — were documented in Weeks 6–8 of the formative stage. A minimum of eight weeks (16 lessons) is recommended for the initial implementation. For sustainable long-term impact on learner proficiency and motivation, integration across a full academic term or year is advised.

These recommendations reflect the specific conditions of rural multilingual schools in the Kyrgyz Republic, where English functions as the third language of instruction and where learner heterogeneity is structurally determined. The level-based model described above is directly applicable within the framework of the existing national curriculum ("Take Off with English", Grades 5–6) and requires no additional institutional resources beyond the teacher's preparation time and commitment to systematic monitoring. Its core principle — that learner diversity is not an obstacle to quality instruction but the very condition that makes differentiated pedagogy both possible and necessary — holds across contexts wherever heterogeneous classrooms and unified educational standards coincide.

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APPENDIX 1

SCORING RUBRICS FOR THE DIAGNOSTIC ASSESSMENT (PRE-TEST) Grade 6 | Subject: English Language | Level: A1.2 (KR State Standard) Form: Integrated Test (Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking, Use of English)

Purpose: Diagnostic assessment of English language proficiency for the formation of differentiated instructional groups.

Table P 1.1.

Overall Score Structure of the Pre-Test

Section	Type of Activity	Instrument	Max. Score
I. Speaking	Oral production	Monologue (25 pts) + Dialogue (25 pts)	50
II. Writing	Written production	Essay 'My Hobby' (5–8 sentences)	15
III. Use of English	Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading	TOWE tasks (Tasks 1, 2, 3, 4)	20
IV. Listening	Aural comprehension	Track 4.2 (8 pts) + Track 4.3 (7 pts)	15
TOTAL			100

PART 1. USE OF ENGLISH (Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading)

Each item is awarded 1 point for a correct answer.

Table P 1.2.

Use of English — Task Structure

Task No.	Object of Assessment	No. of Items	Score
Task 1	Lexical classification (Animals, Food, Hobbies, etc.)	5	5
Task 2	Grammar choice (Verb to be, Present Simple / Continuous)	5	5
Task 3	Productive writing (sentence construction from prompts)	5	5
Task 4	Reading for details	5	5
TOTAL		20	20

PART 2. LISTENING

Tasks are based on audio materials from the TOWE textbook. Only factual accuracy of the answer is assessed.

Table P 1.3.

Listening — Task Structure

Part	Audio Track	Correct Answers	Score	Scoring System
Part 1	Track 4.2	8	8	1 point per correct answer
Part 2	Track 4.3	7	7	1 point per correct answer
TOTAL		15	15	

PART 3. WRITING

Task: Write a coherent text about your hobby (5–8 sentences).

Table P 1.4.

Writing — Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Score	Notes
1	Content (communicative task fulfilment)	5	Full coverage of the topic; required volume maintained.
2	Text organisation	5	Logical sequence; use of connectors (and, but, because).
3	Language accuracy	5	Spelling and grammar (every 2 additional errors = –1 pt).
TOTAL		15	

PART 4. SPEAKING

Part 1. Monologue: 'My Family' Preparation time: 1.5 minutes. Response time: up to 1 minute. Required volume: 6–8 sentences.

Table P 1.5.

Speaking — Monologue Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Max. Score	Notes
1	Communicative task fulfilment (Content)	10	–2 pts for each unaddressed aspect (names, ages, occupations); –4 pts if fewer than 4 sentences produced.
2	Lexico-grammatical accuracy	10	–0.5 pts per significant error (impedes meaning); –0.2 pts per minor error (articles); –1 pt per word used in L1.
3	Phonetic and intonation norms	5	–1 pt per gross mispronunciation of [th], [w], [r] that renders speech unintelligible.
TOTAL		25	

Part 2. Dialogue-Interview (Responses to Questions) Response time: 1 minute. Procedure: the teacher poses 5 fixed questions; the student must provide a complete answer.

Interview questions:

1. What is your name and how old are you?
2. Where are you from and where do you live?
3. Have you got any pets? Tell me about them.
4. What is your favourite school subject and why?
5. What do you usually do after school?

Table P 1.6.

Speaking — Dialogue Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Max. Score	Notes
1	Interaction with the interlocutor	10	–2 pts for a pause exceeding 5 seconds; –2 pts if the student requires the question repeated more than twice.
2	Completeness and relevance of responses	5	–1 pt per monosyllabic response (Yes/No); –1 pt if the response does not correspond to the question.
3	Language accuracy (Grammar)	5	–0.5 pts per error in response structure (incorrect word order, pronoun confusion).
4	Pronunciation and pace	5	–1 pt for an unnaturally slow pace that impedes communication.
TOTAL		25	

PROFICIENCY LEVEL DESCRIPTORS

Table P 1.7.

Proficiency Level Descriptors and Corresponding Instructional Activities

Group (Level)	Score Range	Proficiency Characteristics	Instructional Activities and Tools
Level 1. Correction and Support	0–45	Speaking: speech consists of isolated words or memorised phrases; extended pauses (5–10 sec); cannot construct a sentence independently. Writing: unable to produce a coherent text; writes isolated words or copies from the task; sentences are grammatically unformed. Listening: recognises only familiar isolated words; does not understand the general meaning even upon repeated listening. Reading / Use of English: unable to match letters to sounds; does not know basic sentence construction rules; vocabulary limited to 20–30 words.	Controlled Activities: grammar reference tables, ready-made examples, visual prompts and sentence frames.
Level 2. Standard and Guidance	46–75	Speaking: can construct simple sentences using a model; understands teacher questions and responds, but makes errors in endings (-s) and word order; pace is slow but communication is maintained. Writing: produces a 5–6 sentence text; maintains basic structure but does not use connectors (because, but); makes spelling errors in simple words. Listening: understands the main topic; can extract specific facts (names, ages) when clearly pronounced. Reading / Use of English: reads texts confidently; knows basic	Guided Practice: clear instructions, structured tasks, moderate scaffolding.

		grammar but makes errors in selection or transformation exercises.	
Level 3. Autonomous Development	76– 100	Speaking: fluent speech with virtually no pauses; uses varied adjectives; provides extended answers to 'Why?' questions; virtually no errors in basic structures. Writing: produces a logical, coherent text; uses connectors; demonstrates good spelling. Listening: hears and understands details, context, and the speaker's attitude; completes tasks on first listening. Reading / Use of English: reads quickly, understands not only facts but the logic of the text; completes grammar tests without errors; can explain their choices.	Independent Learning: creative and challenging tasks; content beyond the textbook; independent work.

APPENDIX 2

INSTRUCTIONAL MONITORING PROTOCOLS (IMPs) Formative Stage: January 19 – March 16, 2026 Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School

The Instructional Monitoring Protocol (IMP) is a systematic observation instrument completed by the researcher-teacher during every lesson of the formative stage. Its purpose is to provide a longitudinal qualitative record of each student's task engagement, scaffolding utilisation, frequency of teacher interventions, and individual behavioural dynamics across all 16 lessons of the experimental period.

PART 1. BLANK TEMPLATE – INSTRUCTIONAL MONITORING PROTOCOL

Table P 2.1.

IMP — Header Information

School:	"Amanat" Secondary School, Oktyabr village, Alamudun District, Chuy Region, KR	Date:	
Teacher:		Lesson No.:	
Grade:	6	Unit / Topic:	
Learning Objective:			

Table P 2.2.

IMP — Individual Student Observation Record

Student Code	Assigned Level	Task Completed? (Y/N/Partial)	Scaffold Used? (Y/N)	No. of Teacher Interventions	Qualitative Observation

Table P 2.3.

IMP — Summary Notes

Upward Level Transitions Observed	Overall Lesson Effectiveness (1 — low, 5 — high)	Notes / Adjustments for Next Lesson

APPENDIX 3

DIFFERENTIATED SELF-ASSESSMENT SHEETS Formative Stage: January 19 – March 16, 2026 Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School

Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets were administered to students upon the completion of each thematic unit throughout the formative stage of the experiment. The sheets were calibrated to the proficiency level of each group, ensuring that the language and complexity of the reflective statements were accessible to all participants. Sheets were distributed and completed in the Kyrgyz language to ensure full accessibility in the trilingual learning context of the school. The present appendix contains: Part 1 — blank template sheets in English for all three proficiency levels; Part 2 — completed examples of student self-assessment sheets (original Kyrgyz-language versions, selected from the formative stage).

PART 1. BLANK TEMPLATES (English-language versions)

Template P 3.1.

Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 1: Correction and Support

Student's name: _____	Date: _____
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What did I manage to do today?	Yes / No
I named at least 5 new topic-related vocabulary words using the substitution table.	[]
I understood the difference between the structures provided and used them in my sentences.	[]
I used the substitution table on the board to write 4 sentences in my notebook.	[]
I understood the new vocabulary when the teacher explained it with translation.	[]
My achievement: I managed to write sentences without looking at the table too many times.	

Note to teacher: Sheets for Level 1 were written in Kyrgyz with key English vocabulary items provided in parentheses. The checklist format (Yes/No tick boxes) was selected to minimise the written language demand on students at this proficiency tier.

Template P 3.2.

Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 2: Standard and Guidance

Student's name: _____	Date: _____
------------------------------	--------------------

What did I manage to do today?	Yes / No
I composed a dialogue with my partner and performed it for the class.	[]
I correctly used the dialogue skeleton / structural outline provided on the board.	[]
I completed the listening / reading task independently, without asking for help.	[]
I used the target vocabulary and grammar structures accurately in my responses.	[]

My achievement: I added my own words to the dialogue / task that were not in the skeleton.	
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Note to teacher: Sheets for Level 2 were written in Kyrgyz with English target structures included as references. Students were expected to reflect on the accuracy and independence of their language production.

Template P 3.3.

Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 3: Autonomous Development

Student's name: _____	Date: _____
------------------------------	--------------------

What did I manage to do today?	Yes / No
I prepared and delivered my oral report / task for the class independently.	[]
I described / explained the topic using complex and varied sentences.	[]
I completed all tasks during the lesson fully independently, without any support.	[]
I spoke freely without reading from paper and added vocabulary beyond the lesson input.	[]
My achievement: I helped my classmates understand difficult words or structures in English.	

Note to teacher: Sheets for Level 3 were written in Kyrgyz and included statements requiring critical self-reflection on spontaneous language use, independence, and the ability to support peers. The 'My achievement' prompt was designed to encourage metacognitive awareness.

PART 2. COMPLETED EXAMPLES (Original Kyrgyz-language student self-assessment sheets)

The following pages present selected completed self-assessment sheets from the formative stage of the pedagogical experiment. Sheets are presented in their original Kyrgyz-language format, as administered to students during the experiment. A representative sample of 3–4 completed sheets is provided, drawn from different lessons and proficiency levels.

Sheets included:

Example 1 — Level 1 (Correction and Support): completed sheet, Lesson 1, Unit 4 "The Weather's Very Nice", 19 January 2026.

Example 2 — Level 2 (Standard and Guidance): completed sheet, Lesson 1, Unit 4 "The Weather's Very Nice", 19 January 2026.

Example 3 — Level 3 (Autonomous Development): completed sheet, Lesson 1, Unit 4 "The Weather's Very Nice", 19 January 2026.

[Completed student self-assessment sheets are presented on the following pages as scanned / photographed originals.]

Мен бүгүн эмнени кыла алдым?	Ооба / Жок
Аба ырайы боюнча 5 жаңы сөздү атай алам (sunny, rain ж.б.)	☒
It is (аба ырайы) жана I am (менин сезимим) айырмасын түшүндүм	☒
Доскадагы таблицаны колдонуп, дептериме 4 сүйлөм жаздым	☒
Менин ийгилигим: Таблицаны көп карабай эле, сүйлөмдөрдү өзүм жаздым	☒

Fig. P 3.1. Completed Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 1, Lesson 1 (19 January 2026)

Мен бүгүн эмнени кыла алдым?	Ооба / Жок
Өнөктөшүм менен диалог түзүп, аны класска айтып бердим	☐ ☒
Доскадагы схеманы («Look! It is...») туура колдондум	☐ ☒
2-көнүгүүдө аудиону угуп, сүрөттөрдү туура номерледим	☐ ☒
Менин ийгилигим: Диалогго схемада жок өзүмдүн сөздөрүмдү коштум	☐ ☒

Fig. P 3.2. Completed Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 2, Lesson 1 (19 January 2026)

Мен бүгүн эмнени кыла алдым?	Ооба / Жок
Класс үчүн «Аба ырайы божомолу» аттуу отчетту даярдап, айтып бердим	☒
Ар кандай жерлердеги (тоодо, төмөндө) аба ырайын сүрөттөдүм	☒
Сүйлөгөнүм түшүнүктүү болду жана отчеттун планын толук сактадым	☒
Менин ийгилигим: Кагазды карабай, эркин сүйлөдүм жана татаал сөздөрдү коштум	☒

Fig. P 3.3. Completed Self-Assessment Sheet — Level 3, Lesson 1 (19 January 2026)

APPENDIX 4

SCORING RUBRICS FOR THE SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT (POST-TEST) Grade 6 | Subject: English Language | Level: A1.2 (KR State Standard) Form: Integrated Test (Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking, Use of English)

Purpose: Assessment of the effectiveness of differentiated instruction and the degree of development of basic speech skills following the experimental intervention.

Table P 4.1.

Overall Score Structure of the Post-Test

Section	Type of Activity	Instrument	Max. Score
I. Speaking	Oral production	Monologue (25 pts) + Dialogue (25 pts)	50
II. Writing	Written production	Essay 'My Friend' (8–10 sentences)	15
III. Use of English	Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading	TOWE tasks (Tasks 1, 2, 3, 4)	20
IV. Listening	Aural comprehension	Track 6.1 (10 pts) + Track 6.9 (5 pts)	15
TOTAL			100

PART 1. USE OF ENGLISH (Vocabulary, Grammar, Reading)

Each item is awarded 1 point for a correct answer.

Table P 4.2.

Use of English — Task Structure

Task No.	Object of Assessment	No. of Items	Score
Task 1	Vocabulary task (Weather vocabulary)	5	5
Task 2	Grammar choice (modal verbs)	5	5
Task 3	Productive writing (sentence construction from prompts)	5	5
Task 4	Reading for details (text from pupil's book)	5	5
TOTAL		20	20

PART 2. LISTENING

Tasks are based on audio materials from the TOWE textbook. Only factual accuracy of the answer is assessed.

Table P 4.3.

Listening — Task Structure

Part	Audio Track	Correct Answers	Score	Scoring System
Part 1	Track 6.1	10	10	2 points per correct answer
Part 2	Track 6.9	5	5	1 point per correct answer
TOTAL		15	15	

PART 3. WRITING

Task: Write a coherent text about your friend (8–10 sentences).

Table P 4.4.

Writing — Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Score	Notes
1	Content (communicative task fulfilment)	5	Full coverage of the topic; required volume maintained.
2	Text organisation	5	Logical sequence; use of connectors.
3	Language accuracy	5	Spelling and grammar (every 2 additional errors = –1 pt).
TOTAL		15	

PART 4. SPEAKING

Part 1. Monologue: 'Me and My Appearance' Preparation time: 1.5 minutes. Response time: up to 1 minute. Required volume: 6–8 sentences.

Table P 4.5.

Speaking — Monologue Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Max. Score	Notes
1	Communicative task fulfilment (Content)	10	–1 pt for each unaddressed aspect (name, age, physical description / clothing / character); –4 pts if fewer than 4 sentences produced.
2	Lexico-grammatical accuracy	10	–0.5 pts per significant error (impedes meaning); –0.2 pts per minor error (articles); –1 pt per word used in L1.
3	Phonetic and intonation norms	5	–1 pt per gross mispronunciation of [th], [w], [r] that renders speech unintelligible.
TOTAL		25	

Part 2. Dialogue-Interview (Responses to Questions) Response time: 1 minute. Procedure: the teacher poses 5 fixed questions; the student must provide a complete answer.

Interview questions:

1. What is your name and how old are you?
2. Where are you from and where do you live?
3. Have you got any pets? Tell me about them.
4. What is your favourite school subject and why?
5. What do you usually do after school?

Table P 4.6.

Speaking — Dialogue Assessment Criteria

No.	Assessment Criterion	Max. Score	Notes
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1	Interaction with the interlocutor	10	–2 pts for a pause exceeding 5 seconds; –2 pts if the student requires the question repeated more than twice.
2	Completeness and relevance of responses	5	–1 pt per monosyllabic response (Yes/No); –1 pt if the response does not correspond to the question.
3	Language accuracy (Grammar)	5	–0.5 pts per error in response structure (incorrect word order, pronoun confusion).
4	Pronunciation and pace	5	–1 pt for an unnaturally slow pace that impedes communication.
TOTAL		25	

PROFICIENCY LEVEL DESCRIPTORS

Table P 4.7.

Proficiency Level Descriptors and Achieved Outcomes

Group (Level)	Score Range	Proficiency Characteristics	Achieved Outcomes (Competencies)
Level 1. Correction and Support	0–45	Speaking: speech consists of isolated words or memorised phrases; extended pauses; cannot construct a sentence independently. Writing: unable to produce a coherent text. Listening: recognises only familiar isolated words. Reading / Use of English: unable to match letters to sounds; vocabulary limited to 20–30 words.	Foundational level: the student recognises familiar words and can reproduce memorised phrases. Constant teacher support is required (prompts, L1 translation). The skill of independent sentence construction is still in the process of formation.
Level 2. Standard and Guidance	46–75	Speaking: can construct simple sentences using a model; responds to teacher questions but makes errors in endings and word order; pace is slow but communication is maintained. Writing: produces a 5–6 sentence text with basic structure; no connectors; spelling errors in simple words. Listening: understands main topic; extracts specific facts when clearly pronounced. Reading / Use of English: reads confidently; knows basic grammar but makes errors in transformation exercises.	Standard level: the student manages textbook tasks. Can compose a text using a model, understands basic teacher questions, and demonstrates knowledge of basic grammar (to be, Present Simple), although errors may occur in spontaneous responses.

Level 3. Autonomous Development	76– 100	Speaking: fluent speech with virtually no pauses; uses varied adjectives; provides extended answers to 'Why?' questions; virtually no errors in basic structures. Writing: produces a logical, coherent text using connectors; good spelling. Listening: understands details, context, and speaker attitude; completes tasks on first listening. Reading / Use of English: reads quickly, understands text logic; completes grammar tests without errors.	Full programme mastery: the student has assimilated all course topics. Can speak about themselves, hobbies, or a friend without visual supports or tables; able to add 1–2 original sentences beyond the model. Speech is sufficiently fluent for the age group; audio comprehension is achieved on first listening.
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APPENDIX 5

INDIVIDUAL PRE-TEST RESULTS — ALL 24 PARTICIPANTS Diagnostic Assessment | January 12–14, 2026 Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School | Subject: English Language

The table below presents the individual scores obtained by all 24 participants in the diagnostic pre-test administered at the outset of the formative stage (January 12–14, 2026). Results are disaggregated by skill domain and presented alongside the proficiency level assigned to each student on the basis of their cumulative score. Student names have been replaced with anonymised codes (S1–S24) in accordance with research ethics requirements.

Table P 5.1.

Individual Pre-Test Results by Skill Domain and Proficiency Level (n=24)

No.	Student Code	Speaking		Listening /15	Writing /15	Use of English			TOTAL /100	Level
		Monologue /25	Dialogue /25			Grammar /10	Vocabulary /5	Reading /5		
1	S1	3	5	3	1	4	3		19	Level 1
2	S2	7	10	5	1	1	2	1	27	Level 1
3	S3	7	1	6	1	1	5	1	22	Level 1
4	S4	15	7	9	6	2	5	2	46	Level 2
5	S5	12	7	5	3	3.5	3	4	37.5	Level 1
6	S6	18	20	8	8	4	5	5	68	Level 2
7	S7	2	3	4	1	3	1	1	15	Level 1
8	S8	14	10	6	7	6.5	5	5	53.5	Level 2
9	S9	21	21	5	5	6	3	4	65	Level 2
10	S10	13	16	5	2	5	3		44	Level 1
11	S11	15	2	4	3	3	5	3	35	Level 1

12	S12	1	1	3	1	3	1	1	11	Level 1
13	S13	16	11	8	2	5	5	3.5	50.5	Level 2
14	S14	3	5	5	1	4	3	1	21	Level 1
15	S15	22	24	12	13	6	5	5	87	Level 3
16	S16	1	1	6	5	1	5		19	Level 1
17	S17	18	20	13	12	6	5	4	78	Level 3
18	S18	2	2	2	2	5	5		18	Level 1
19	S19	16	18	9	4	3	5	5	60	Level 2
20	S20		1	2	1				4	Level 1
21	S21	20	15	10	4	5	4	5	63	Level 2
22	S22	3	1	2	1	2	2		11	Level 1
23	S23	17	17	6	7	6	5	5	63	Level 2
24	S24	3	1	3	1	2	2	2	13.5	Level 1
—	Class Mean	10.4	9.1	5.9	3.8	3.6	3.6	2.4	38.8	—

Colour coding: Level 1 (pink) — Correction and Support (0–45 pts); Level 2 (blue) — Standard and Guidance (46–75 pts); Level 3 (green) — Autonomous Development (76–100 pts).

Table P 5.2.

Distribution of Students by Proficiency Level

Proficiency Level	No. of Students	% of Class	Score Range
Level 1 — Correction and Support	14	58.3%	0–45
Level 2 — Standard and Guidance	8	33.3%	46–75
Level 3 — Autonomous Development	2	8.3%	76–100

TOTAL	24	100%	—
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EXAMPLE OF AI-ASSISTED DIFFERENTIATED TASK ADAPTATION Lesson 1 | Unit 4: "The Weather's Very Nice" | 19 January 2026 Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School

The present appendix illustrates the procedure of AI-assisted task adaptation as applied to the productive stage of Lesson 1 of the formative experiment. In accordance with the methodology described in Section 3.1.3, the researcher submitted the original textbook exercise, the thematic objective of the lesson, and the pedagogical profiles of the three proficiency groups as input to an AI language generation tool (Google Gemini). The tool generated three differentiated task variants, which the researcher reviewed, refined where necessary, and integrated into the lesson plan. The procedure was replicated systematically across all 16 lessons of the formative stage.

STEP 1. INPUT PROVIDED TO THE AI TOOL

The following information was submitted as input:

Source material: Take Off with English, Grade 6, Unit 4, pp. 30–31 (Marshall Cavendish Education). Lesson topic: The Weather's Very Nice. Grammar focus: Present Simple to express general facts about weather (It is + [weather adjective]; I am + [state adjective]). New vocabulary: cloudy, cold, hot, ice, rain, snow, sunny, weather, wet, wind, windy. Textbook exercises (shared input): Exercise 1 — Listen and point (dialogues between Pex and Max); Exercise 2 — Listen and write numbers (audio-based picture sequencing). Both exercises to be completed frontally by the whole class during the presentation and controlled practice stages. Task: Generate three differentiated productive-stage tasks for the same lesson — one for each of the three proficiency groups described below — maintaining a unified thematic framework. Group profiles: Level 1 (n=14, score 0–45): Cannot construct independent sentences; requires maximum scaffolding; active vocabulary limited to 20–30 words. Level 2 (n=8, score 46–75): Can construct simple sentences using a model; able to sustain basic communicative exchanges with guidance. Level 3 (n=2, score 76–100): Fluent production; able to work fully independently; requires creative and cognitively demanding tasks.

STEP 2. AI-GENERATED OUTPUT (reviewed and adapted by the researcher)

The AI tool generated the following three differentiated task variants. Minor lexical and structural corrections were introduced by the researcher prior to classroom implementation.

Table P 6.1.

Three-Level Task Matrix — Productive Stage, Lesson 1 (19 January 2026)

Parameter	LEVEL 1 Correction and Support (n=14)	LEVEL 2 Standard and Guidance (n=8)	LEVEL 3 Autonomous Development (n=2)
Activity Type	Controlled Activity — Written sentence construction	Guided Practice — Oral dialogue composition	Independent Learning — Oral weather report
Task Description	Write 4 simple sentences about the weather using the substitution table provided on the board. Use the visual prompts from p. 30 of the textbook.	Choose one picture from Exercise 1 (p. 30) and compose a short dialogue with your partner (4 lines minimum) using the dialogue skeleton provided.	Prepare and deliver an oral weather report based on the full illustration (pp. 30–31). Describe weather conditions in at least two different locations shown.
Scaffolding Tool	Substitution Table (on board):	Dialogue Skeleton (on board):	Report Outline (distributed on card): <i>1. Hello! I am [name].</i>

	<i>It is + [sunny / rainy / snowing / windy / cloudy] I am + [hot / cold / wet] Bilingual vocabulary list (EN–KY) on desk.</i>	<i>— Look! It is [weather]. — Yes, it is. — I am [feeling]. — Me too! / I am not.</i>	<i>2. Today the weather is very different. 3. In the mountains it is... 4. In the jungle it is... 5. Have a nice day!</i>
Expected Student Output	<i>"It is snowing. I am cold. It is sunny. I am hot." (4 grammatically correct sentences using the substitution table)</i>	<i>"— Look! It is raining. — Yes, it is. — I am wet. — I am not wet." (dialogue with optional personal addition)</i>	<i>"Hello! Today in the mountains it is snowing and cold. In the jungle it is hot and sunny. Have a nice day!" (independent extended oral production)</i>
Bloom's Taxonomy Level	Knowledge / Comprehension	Application / Analysis	Synthesis / Evaluation

STEP 3. RESEARCHER'S ADAPTATIONS AND METHODOLOGICAL NOTES

Following the AI-generated output, the researcher introduced the following modifications prior to classroom implementation:

1. Level 1 scaffolding: The substitution table was simplified to include only the most frequent weather items introduced in Audio 4.1, omitting less common vocabulary (ice, wet) that had not yet been sufficiently practised at the receptive level. A bilingual (English–Kyrgyz) word list was added to the printed handout to reduce cognitive load.

2. Level 2 dialogue skeleton: The original AI-generated skeleton contained five lines; this was reduced to four to match the time available for the productive stage (15 minutes) and to ensure that all Level 2 pairs could complete and rehearse their dialogue within the allotted time.

3. Level 3 report outline: The researcher added a specific instruction to describe weather conditions in at least two distinct locations visible in the illustration (mountains and jungle), thereby ensuring a minimum output standard while preserving the open-ended character of the task.

The adapted tasks were printed as individual handouts and distributed discreetly to each proficiency group at the start of the productive stage. The distribution procedure was designed to prevent ability labelling: handouts were placed face-down on desks prior to the lesson and turned over simultaneously by all students upon the teacher's instruction.

STEP 4. OUTCOME OBSERVED IN LESSON 1

The following outcomes were documented in the Instructional Monitoring Protocol for Lesson 1 (see Appendix 2):

Level 1: Approximately 4 of 14 students did not initially consult the substitution table, producing isolated words rather than complete sentences. Following individual teacher modelling during the productive stage, all 14 students produced at least 2 complete sentences by the end of the 15-minute period. By Lesson 3, scaffold utilisation had become habitual for the majority of the group.

Level 2: All 8 students completed their dialogues within the allotted time. One student (S9) added an independent sentence beyond the skeleton — the first documented instance of autonomous language production in this group, recorded as an early indicator of potential upward level transition.

Level 3: Both students (S15, S17) delivered complete oral weather reports without external support. S15 incorporated three weather terms not present in the lesson input, demonstrating productive vocabulary use beyond the immediate instructional context.

Note: The AI-assisted task adaptation procedure described above was applied consistently across all 16 lessons of the formative stage. The complete set of differentiated handouts is retained in the researcher's working documentation.

LESSON PLAN Unit 4: "The Weather's Very Nice" | Lesson 1 of the Formative Stage 19
January 2026 | Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School

Subject:	English	Date:	19 January 2026
Grade:	6	Lesson No.:	1 (Formative Stage)
School:	"Amanat" Secondary School, Oktyabr village, Alamudun District, Chuy Region, KR	Teacher:	Sultangazy kyzy Zhenishkul
Unit / Topic:	Unit 4 "The Weather's Very Nice" (Pupil's Book, pp. 30–31)	No. of Students:	24
Materials:	Pupil's Book, audio tracks 4.1 / 4.2 / 4.3, board, differentiated printed handouts, bilingual word lists	Duration:	45 minutes

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- identify and pronounce 11 weather-related vocabulary items (cloudy, cold, hot, ice, rain, snow, sunny, weather, wet, wind, windy) introduced via audio input;
- construct simple sentences using Present Simple structures to describe weather conditions (It is + [weather adjective]) and personal states (I am + [state adjective]);
- engage in level-appropriate productive language use at the differentiated productive stage — written sentence construction (Level 1), oral dialogue composition (Level 2), or independent oral weather reporting (Level 3).

Lesson Procedure

Lesson Stage	Teacher's Activity	Students' Activity	Assessment / Differentiation
STAGE I Warm-up 5 min <i>Whole class</i> <i>No differentiation</i>	Teacher greets students and establishes a positive classroom climate. Conducts the game "What's in the bag?": • Displays flashcards depicting weather conditions (sun, snowflake, rain) and realia items (umbrella, sunglasses, scarf).	Students greet the teacher. Students observe the flashcards / realia and respond chorally and individually: • "It's an umbrella — for rainy weather!" • "It's for cold weather."	Diagnostic Teacher observes student readiness and monitors prior vocabulary knowledge informally. No written assessment.

	• Poses questions to the whole class: "What's this? Is it for hot or cold weather?" • Elicits choral and individual responses to activate prior vocabulary. Purpose: activation of background knowledge; establishing psychological comfort and communicative readiness.	All three proficiency groups participate equally in this stage.	
STAGE II Presentation 10 min <i>Whole class</i> <i>No differentiation</i>	Introduces new weather vocabulary using Audio 4.1: • Points to each word in the vocabulary box (pp. 30–31) as it is heard. • Replays the audio; models pronunciation with clear articulation. • Translates key terms into Kyrgyz where necessary (especially for Level 1 learners) to ensure full comprehension. Conducts a choral drill: repeats each word with the class 2–3 times. Plays Audio 4.2 (Exercise 1 — dialogue between Pex and Max): • Instructs students to follow the text in their books and point to the	Students follow the vocabulary in the book and point to each word as it is heard. Students repeat each new word chorally after the audio and after the teacher. Students listen to Audio 4.2 and point to the corresponding picture (Ex. 1, p. 30) for each dialogue. Students repeat key dialogue lines chorally: • "It's hot. — Yes. — I'm hot. — I'm hot too." • "It's cold. — I'm cold too. It's snowing." Students observe the grammatical	Formative Teacher monitors pronunciation accuracy during choral repetition. Teacher notes students who struggle with specific phonemes for targeted support in subsequent stages. No differentiation at this stage — unified input for all groups.

	corresponding picture as each dialogue is heard. - Replays the audio, pausing after each dialogue for students to repeat the key lines chorally. Grammatical focus: introduces the two target structures on the board: - It is + [weather adjective] → It is sunny. It is snowing. - I am + [state adjective] → I am hot. I am cold.	structures written on the board.	
STAGE III Controlled Practice 10 min <i>Whole class</i> <i>Partial differentiation</i>	Conducts Exercise 2 (p. 30) — "Listen and write numbers": - Reviews the vocabulary: "Show me [snowing]." Students point to the corresponding picture. - Plays Audio 4.3. Uses the example (Picture C = 1) to explain the task. - Replays the audio, pausing after each item for students to write the number. Checks answers as a class: - Teacher names a letter (A–H); students call out the number and the weather word. - Example: "A is 3. It's hot."	Students review vocabulary by pointing to pictures on command. Students listen to Audio 4.3 and write the corresponding number next to each picture (A–H). During the checking phase, students call out the number and word for each picture. Level 1 students use the bilingual word list to support recognition of spoken vocabulary items.	Formative Whole-class oral checking of answers. Teacher monitors Level 1 students' ability to match spoken vocabulary to visual prompts — key data point for IMP. Partial differentiation: scaffolding (bilingual word list) provided only to Level 1.

	Differentiated support during this stage: • Level 1 students receive a bilingual word list (EN–KY) on their desk prior to listening to reduce cognitive load. • Level 2 and 3 students complete the task according to the standard textbook instructions. Answers: A=3, B=7, C=1 (example), D=4, E=8, F=2, G=6, H=5.	Level 2 and 3 students complete the exercise without additional support.	
STAGE IV Productive Stage 15 min FULL DIFFERENTIATION <i>Three-tier task matrix</i>	Distributes individual printed handouts discreetly to each proficiency group (face-down; students turn over on teacher's signal). Writes the three task frameworks on the board simultaneously: LEVEL 1 — Board (left): • It is + [sunny / rainy / snowing / windy / cloudy] • I am + [hot / cold / wet] <i>Task: Write 4 sentences about the weather in the pictures (p. 30).</i> LEVEL 2 — Board (centre): • — Look! It is ... • — Yes, it is. • — I am ...	Students turn over their handouts and begin work on their level-appropriate task. LEVEL 1 students: • Use the substitution table on the board to construct 4 written sentences. • Refer to the bilingual word list on their desk if needed. • Example output: "It is snowing. I am cold. It is sunny. I am hot." LEVEL 2 students: • Choose one of the four weather situations from Ex. 1 (p. 30).	Formative FULL DIFFERENTIATION Level 1: Scaffold utilisation documented in IMP. Criteria: correct sentence structure; use of target vocabulary. Level 2: Accuracy of dialogue structure; whether independent additions are made beyond the skeleton (upward transition indicator). Level 3: Fluency; range of vocabulary; ability to describe multiple locations independently. Teacher completes IMP during this stage.

	• — Me too! / I am not. <i>Task: Choose one picture from Ex. 1 and compose a short dialogue with your partner.</i> LEVEL 3 — Card (distributed): • 1. Hello! I am [name]. • 2. Today the weather is... • 3. In the mountains it is... / In the jungle it is... • 4. Have a nice day! <i>Task: Prepare and deliver an oral weather report based on the full illustration (pp. 30–31).</i> Teacher circulates: • Provides individual modelling for Level 1 students who do not initially use the substitution table. • Monitors Level 2 pairs and prompts where necessary. • Observes Level 3 students' autonomous production without intervention. Documents observations in the Instructional Monitoring Protocol (IMP).	• Compose a 4-line dialogue with their partner using the skeleton on the board. • Rehearse and prepare to perform the dialogue for the class. • May add one independent sentence beyond the skeleton. LEVEL 3 students: • Study the full illustration (pp. 30–31) independently. • Prepare an oral weather report following the outline on their card. • Deliver the report without reading from notes. • May add details about temperature, clothing, or activities beyond the outline.	
STAGE V Conclusion Reflection 5 min	& Organises presentations: • Level 3 students deliver their	Level 3 students present their weather reports orally to the class.	Formative Peer modelling opportunity: Level 3

<i>Whole class</i>	weather reports to the class. • One Level 2 pair performs their dialogue. • Level 1 students submit written sentences for teacher review. Poses oral feedback questions to the whole class: • "Who found the substitution table helpful today?" • "Who managed to say how they feel about the weather?" Records responses in the IMP as qualitative evidence. Distributes Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets (in Kyrgyz) upon completion of the thematic unit (see Appendix 3). Sets homework: relevant Workbook exercise (Unit 4).	One Level 2 pair performs their dialogue. Level 1 students hand in their written sentences. All students respond to the teacher's feedback questions. Students complete the Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheet (Kyrgyz-language version). Students record the homework assignment.	output serves as a language model for other groups. Self-assessment data collected via Differentiated Self-Assessment Sheets (see Appendix 3). IMP completed in full.
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Note: This lesson plan represents the first session of the formative stage of the pedagogical experiment (January 19 – March 16, 2026). The five-stage lesson structure, the three-tier differentiated task matrix, and the Instructional Monitoring Protocol applied in this lesson were replicated systematically across all 16 lessons of the formative stage. The complete set of lesson plans is retained in the researcher's working documentation.

APPENDIX 8

POST-TEST RESULTS AND COMPARATIVE PROGRESS DATA — ALL 24 PARTICIPANTS Summative Assessment: March 23–24, 2026 Grade 6 | "Amanat" Secondary School | Subject: English Language

The tables below present the individual post-test results for all 24 participants, disaggregated by skill domain, alongside each student's pre-test total score and the resulting growth figure. Level transitions are indicated where applicable. Pre-test individual skill data are presented in Appendix 5. Student names have been replaced with anonymised codes (S1–S24). Upward level transitions are marked ↑ and highlighted in yellow.

Table P 8.1.

Individual Post-Test Results, Pre-Test Totals, and Growth Data (n=24)

No.	Student Code	Mono /25	Dial /25	List /15	Writ /15	Gram /10	Voc /5	Read /5	Post-Test Total /100	Pre-Test Total /100	Growth (pts)	Level Transition
1	S1	6	5	10.6	3	6.5	5	1	37.1	19	+18.1	Level 1 → Level 1
2	S2	7	7	9.3	3	5	5	3	39.3	27	+12.3	Level 1 → Level 1
3	S3	4		9.3	2	4	5	2	26.3	22	+4.3	Level 1 → Level 1
4	S4	7	7	12.6	11	10	5	3	55.6	46	+9.6	Level 2 → Level 2
5	S5	10	10	11.8	9.8	8	5	4.5	59.1	37.5	+21.6	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
6	S6	21	17	11.3	10.5	9	3	3	74.8	68	+6.8	Level 2 → Level 2
7	S7	2	2	9.8	1	3	3	2	22.8	15	+7.8	Level 1 → Level 1
8	S8	8	12	13	12	10	5	3	63	53.5	+9.5	Level 2 → Level 2
9	S9	24	19	13	12	8	5	3	84	65	+19.0	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
10	S10	15	15	5.8	4	4.5	5	4	53.3	44	+9.3	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
11	S11	10	6	12.4	6	8	5	3	50.4	35	+15.4	Level 1 → Level 2 ↑
12	S12	4	1	7.8	6	4	5	2	29.8	11	+18.8	Level 1 → Level 1
13	S13	20	6	13	9	5.3	5	3	61.3	50.5	+10.8	Level 2 → Level 2
14	S14	2	2	10	3	2	5	1	25	21	+4.0	Level 1 → Level 1

15	S15	24	20	14	13	10	5	5	91	87	+4.0	Level 3 → Level 3
16	S16	5	7	10.1	5	8	5	2	42.1	19	+23.1	Level 1 → Level 1
17	S17	22	18	14	13	10	5	4.5	86.5	78	+8.5	Level 3 → Level 3
18	S18	4	2	6.5	5	6	5	4	32.5	18	+14.5	Level 1 → Level 1
19	S19	21	17	13	10	9	5	3.5	78.5	60	+18.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
20	S20	2	1	5.8	1	4	2	3	18.8	4	+14.8	Level 1 → Level 1
21	S21	22	18	15	8	5	5	3.5	76.5	63	+13.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
22	S22	3	3	6.5	1	2	2	1	18.5	11	+7.5	Level 1 → Level 1
23	S23	19	19	13	10	7	5	4.5	77.5	63	+14.5	Level 2 → Level 3 ↑
24	S24	5	3	10	3	8	5	3	37	13.5	+23.5	Level 1 → Level 1
—	Mean	11.1	9.0	10.7	6.7	6.5	4.6	3.0	51.7	38.8	+12.9	7 upward transitions total

Abbreviations: Mono = Monologue /25; Dial = Dialogue /25; List = Listening /15; Writ = Writing /15; Gram = Grammar /10; Voc = Vocabulary /5; Read = Reading /5.

Colour coding: green = Post-Test scores; orange = Pre-Test total (for reference); yellow = upward level transitions or mean row.

Table P 8.2.

Comparative Skill-Level Analysis: Class Mean Scores Pre-Test vs. Post-Test

Skill Domain	Pre-Test Mean	Post-Test Mean	Absolute Growth	Relative Growth (% of max)
Speaking — Monologue (/25)	10.4	11.1	+0.7	+2.9%
Speaking — Dialogue (/25)	9.2	9.0	+0.2	+0.6%
Listening (/15)	6.5	10.7	+4.2	+28.2%
Writing (/15)	4.2	6.7	+2.5	+16.8%
Grammar (/10)	3.7	6.5	+2.8	+28.1%
Vocabulary (/5)	3.6	4.6	+1.0	+19.7%
Reading (/5)	2.6	3.0	+0.4	+7.6%
TOTAL (/100)	37.6	51.7	+14.1	+14.1%

Pre-test mean scores are taken from the diagnostic assessment (January 12–14, 2026). See Appendix 5 for full pre-test data.

Table P 8.3.

Distribution of Students by Proficiency Level: Pre-Test vs. Post-Test

Proficiency Level	Pre-Test (n)	Pre-Test (%)	Post-Test (n)	Post-Test (%)
Level 1 — Correction and Support (0–45)	14	58.3%	11	45.8%
Level 2 — Standard and Guidance (46–75)	8	33.3%	7	29.2%
Level 3 — Autonomous Development (76–100)	2	8.3%	6	25.0%
TOTAL	24	100%	24	100%

Note: The net decrease in Level 2 (8 → 7) reflects inward mobility from Level 1 (+3 students) offset by outward mobility to Level 3 (–4 students). Total upward transitions: 7 (3 from Level 1 to Level 2; 4 from Level 2 to Level 3).